

Sport Pilot

Flight Lesson Guide

Original instructor flight steps aligned to the current portal's 46-lesson Sport syllabus, actual preparation assignments and lesson-page targets. The publisher resource is dated October 2025 even though it is delivered by the current 2026 Sport course. Current FAA PTS and Part 61 govern eligibility, operating limits and final assessment. Two stages build daytime control/solo readiness, then field performance and visual navigation. The 60-minute dual plus 36-minute solo first-solo mission stays explicitly compound; broad lists have named required unfinished work rather than clock-based mastery.

Sporty's current Sport course portal TCO, October 2025 edition; original teaching guide with current June 2026 Sport PTS overlay

Use this guide

Read the full teaching guide before flight. Use the compact checklist to sequence the flight. Minutes are pacing targets; repeat, stop, or defer an exercise when proficiency, conditions, or available time require it. Checkmarks indicate items covered, not a proficiency endorsement.

Aircraft values come from the applicable POH/AFM and approved checklist. Brief the aircraft-specific speeds, configurations, limitations, and any simulation method before conducting a maneuver.

Entry and preparation

- Train with an authorized instructor in a specifically verified eligible airplane; confirm all current Sport privileges/limitations, endorsements and personal eligibility before any operation.
- Establish the applicable student solo eligibility/endorsements and flight-training proficiency before instructor release.
- Reconcile actual total, instructor, solo, cross-country, full-stop and recent test-preparation experience against current Part 61; publisher targets are planning estimates.

Sources and alignment

Sporty's current Sport Pilot TCO resource - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Current Sport airplane Practical Test Standards - FAA-S-8081-29B, June 2026, effective September 14, 2026

Current Part 61 Sport privileges, aircraft eligibility and experience - Current eCFR verified October 10, 2026

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Control and supervised solo

Aircraft/airport preparation, basic control, near-stall/full-stall recovery, wind/emergency skills and an independent solo-readiness gate before supervised pattern solo.

Lesson 1 · Aircraft preparation

Study airworthiness, documents, inspections and a deliberate walkaround before the first flight.

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Ground preparation objectives

- Study airworthiness, documents, inspections and a deliberate walkaround before the first flight.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segments 1-13](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 2 · First flight: control, trim and the traffic pattern

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72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-32 Air 08-24	[] Sight picture, climb, level flight and descent	1.
32-42 Air 24-34	[] Airspeed changes and trim	1.
42-58 Air 34-50	[] Coordinated turns to headings	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 2

Introduce the airplane as a controllable system. Build an outside sight picture and positive control transfer; the instructor still demonstrates and assists takeoff and landing.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Introduce the airplane as a controllable system. Build an outside sight picture and positive control transfer; the instructor still demonstrates and assists takeoff and landing.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Sight picture, climb, level flight and descent; Airspeed changes and trim; Coordinated turns to headings.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Model each action and explain it before the learner attempts it. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate the outside references and coach control inputs; retain responsibility for the landing/takeoff outcome. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Sight picture, climb, level flight and descent · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: At a safe cruise altitude, point out the horizon position for level flight. Show how a small pitch change moves the horizon, then coordinate power for a climb. Anticipate level-off, set cruise power and trim. Show a descent and level-off in the same order.

Student exercise: 1. Describe the outside attitude and cross-check the instruments. 2. Hold straight flight with coordinated rudder. 3. Establish the briefed climb airspeed and level at the assigned altitude. 4. Establish a descent, then restore level flight. 5. State what pitch and power changed.

Practice: One instructor sequence, then two student climb-level-descent sequences; use smaller changes if the learner is overloaded.

Look for: Recognizes the changing sight picture, coordinates pitch and power and levels with timely coaching; initial-flight assistance is expected.

Watch / correct: Chasing the vertical-speed indication - return eyes to the horizon and make one small pitch correction.

Watch / correct: Ball displaced during a power change - add the appropriate rudder while keeping wings level.

Stop / transition: Restore ordinary cruise if traffic, turbulence or workload prevents an outside scan; instructor takes control before an unsafe altitude or airspeed develops.

Reference: AFH: basic flight maneuvers; PHAK: flight controls and instruments

Airspeed changes and trim · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show cruise-to-low-cruise airspeed by setting power, holding altitude with pitch and trimming only after the attitude is established. Reverse the sequence to cruise and demonstrate how trim relieves force without setting the flight path.

Student exercise: 1. Choose the assigned airspeed and configuration within the POH limits. 2. Change power while holding altitude. 3. Stabilize the attitude, then trim. 4. Return to cruise. 5. Explain which control establishes attitude and which relieves pressure.

Practice: Two complete speed transitions, with one hands-light trim check after stabilization.

Look for: Controls altitude through a speed change, avoids chasing trim and verifies the airplane stays stable when control pressure is relaxed.

Watch / correct: Using trim as the primary pitch control - establish attitude with the elevator before trimming.

Watch / correct: Adding power without compensating pitch - anticipate the attitude change and recheck altitude.

Stop / transition: Leave the exercise before stall warning, a configuration limit or an unsafe altitude trend; use the recovery already taught rather than continuing a speed target.

Reference: AFH: straight-and-level flight, transitions and trim

Coordinated turns to headings · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show clearing, an outside bank reference and coordinated rudder. Compare a shallow turn with a medium-bank turn, then show leading the rollout to capture a heading without skidding.

Student exercise: 1. Clear toward the turn. 2. Enter the briefed bank with coordinated controls. 3. Maintain the outside pitch picture. 4. Anticipate rollout to the chosen heading. 5. Re-trim only when stable and reverse direction after another clearing scan.

Practice: Two turns in each direction, using different heading changes and one deliberate rollout correction.

Look for: Maintains a coordinated turn, identifies altitude drift and rolls out smoothly with decreasing instructor assistance.

Watch / correct: Staring at the heading instrument - use it briefly and return to the outside reference.

Watch / correct: Using rudder alone to hurry the rollout - reduce bank with coordinated aileron and rudder.

Stop / transition: Roll wings level and discontinue if the turn is uncoordinated, traffic appears or the learner loses the altitude/airspeed picture.

Reference: AFH: turns; PHAK: adverse yaw and coordination

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate the pattern, aiming picture, flare and directional control, then allow only the participation the learner can safely manage. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Student performs preparation/start/taxi checks and elementary control with appropriate instructor help; independent landing proficiency is not expected.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segments 12-24

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 2 - source page 11 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 3 · Airport and taxi preparation

Prepare airport signs, markings, pattern rules and runway-incursion prevention before further taxi/pattern practice.

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Ground preparation objectives

- Prepare airport signs, markings, pattern rules and runway-incursion prevention before further taxi/pattern practice.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segments 3-20](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segment 14](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 15](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 3](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 4 · Aerodynamics preparation

Prepare lift, angle of attack, drag and stall recognition for the first low-speed lesson.

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Ground preparation objectives

- Prepare lift, angle of attack, drag and stall recognition for the first low-speed lesson.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segments 21-26](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segment 5](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segment 6](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 5 · Slow flight and first-indication stall recovery

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72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-34 Air 08-26	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
34-58 Air 26-50	[] Recognize and recover at the first stall indication	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 5

Introduce low-speed handling and recovery at the first stall cue. Keep the first stall lesson distinct from the later full-stall lessons.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Introduce low-speed handling and recovery at the first stall cue. Keep the first stall lesson distinct from the later full-stall lessons.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Recognize and recover at the first stall indication.
- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Use the currently effective Sport airplane PTS task, which specifies the near-stall condition at which another increase in angle of attack/load or reduction in power would produce an immediate stall. Clear, choose a safe recovery floor that permits completion at or above the PTS minimum of 1,500 feet AGL, and follow all aircraft limitations.

Demonstrate coordinated straight flight, gentle turns, climb and descent with the requested approved configurations, then recover to cruise. This Sport task differs from the private-certificate slow-flight condition.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One entry, two shallow turns and one recovery; repeat the entry only after identifying the largest error.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Recognize and recover at the first stall indication · 24 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Demonstrate one approach-type and one departure-type entry in the approved aircraft configuration. Name the cues as they appear. Recover at the first stall indication by reducing angle of attack and using the POH recovery sequence; do not continue to a full stall in this exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Clear, set the configuration and verify the recovery floor. 2. Enter the instructor-briefed approach scenario. 3. Call the first stall cue and begin recovery immediately. 4. Re-establish stable flight. 5. Repeat for a departure scenario, staying coordinated throughout.

Practice: One instructor example of each entry; one student recovery of each if readiness and altitude allow.

Look for: Names the warning cues and reduces angle of attack without delay; assisted recovery is acceptable on the introduction lesson.

Watch / correct: Trying to climb out by pulling - reduce angle of attack first, then apply approved power.

Watch / correct: Applying aileron aggressively with yaw present - restore coordination and follow the POH stall recovery.

Stop / transition: Instructor intervenes before an uncoordinated stall or spin tendency; recover by the agreed altitude. This lesson does not authorize intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: stall recognition and prevention; POH: stall recovery

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.

- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

- Student explains the new exercise and performs its sequence with the assistance appropriate to introduction, followed by a corrected repeat when safe.

Debrief - 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segments 19-26

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 5 - source page 14 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 6 · Stability, load and wake preparation

Explain stability, coordination, load factor and wake avoidance before more precise control work.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain stability, coordination, load factor and wake avoidance before more precise control work.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 21](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 7 · Precise speed, heading and altitude transitions

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-24 Air 08-16	[] Airspeed changes and trim	1.
24-36 Air 16-28	[] Constant-airspeed climbs, descents and altitude captures	1.
36-44 Air 28-36	[] Coordinated turns to headings	1.
44-52 Air 36-44	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
52-58 Air 44-50	[] Recognize and recover at the first stall indication	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 7

Introduce constant-airspeed climbs/descents, altitude captures, speed/trim transitions and medium-bank heading changes. Review near-stall handling and first-indication recoveries; selected-rate work is introduced in Lesson 11.

Source clarification: The six-minute imminent-stall block is a short review. Extend/repeat if either entry needs a fresh demonstration or corrected repetitions; do not replace the first-indication exercise with full stalls.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Introduce constant-airspeed climbs/descents, altitude captures, speed/trim transitions and medium-bank heading changes. Review near-stall handling and first-indication recoveries; selected-rate work is introduced in Lesson 11.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Airspeed changes and trim; Constant-airspeed and constant-rate altitude changes; Coordinated turns to headings; Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Recognize and

recover at the first stall indication.

- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Airspeed changes and trim · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show cruise-to-low-cruise airspeed by setting power, holding altitude with pitch and trimming only after the attitude is established. Reverse the sequence to cruise and demonstrate how trim relieves force without setting the flight path.

Student exercise: 1. Choose the assigned airspeed and configuration within the POH limits. 2. Change power while holding altitude. 3. Stabilize the attitude, then trim. 4. Return to cruise. 5. Explain which control establishes attitude and which relieves pressure.

Practice: Two complete speed transitions, with one hands-light trim check after stabilization.

Look for: Controls altitude through a speed change, avoids chasing trim and verifies the airplane stays stable when control pressure is relaxed.

Watch / correct: Using trim as the primary pitch control - establish attitude with the elevator before trimming.

Watch / correct: Adding power without compensating pitch - anticipate the attitude change and recheck altitude.

Stop / transition: Leave the exercise before stall warning, a configuration limit or an unsafe altitude trend; use the recovery already taught rather than continuing a speed target.

Reference: AFH: straight-and-level flight, transitions and trim

Constant-airspeed climbs, descents and altitude captures · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate aircraft-appropriate pitch/power for a constant-airspeed climb and descent, with an anticipated level-off. Explain the difference between establishing airspeed and chasing vertical rate. Keep this lesson on airspeed control; selected-rate climbs/descents are introduced in Lesson 11.

Student exercise: 1. Brief the altitude and POH/assigned airspeed. 2. Establish the constant-airspeed climb with coordinated controls. 3. Lead the level-off and set cruise/trim. 4. Repeat in a constant-airspeed descent. 5. Explain the pitch/power correction used when speed drifted.

Practice: Two climb-level-descent sequences at constant airspeed, with a safe reset and one diagnosed correction.

Look for: Selects the proper pitch/power combination, anticipates level-off and corrects a trend before it becomes a large deviation.

Watch / correct: Fixating on rate while airspeed decays - restore a safe pitch/airspeed and reduce the rate target.

Watch / correct: Leveling late - announce the approaching altitude and begin the transition earlier.

Stop / transition: Level off or restore cruise if assigned airspace, terrain clearance or an airspeed/configuration limit would be approached.

Reference: AFH: climbs and descents; PHAK: instruments

Coordinated turns to headings · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show clearing, an outside bank reference and coordinated rudder. Compare a shallow turn with a medium-bank turn, then show leading the rollout to capture a heading without skidding.

Student exercise: 1. Clear toward the turn. 2. Enter the briefed bank with coordinated controls. 3. Maintain the outside pitch picture. 4. Anticipate rollout to the chosen heading. 5. Re-trim only when stable and reverse direction after another clearing scan.

Practice: Two turns in each direction, using different heading changes and one deliberate rollout correction.

Look for: Maintains a coordinated turn, identifies altitude drift and rolls out smoothly with decreasing instructor assistance.

Watch / correct: Staring at the heading instrument - use it briefly and return to the outside reference.

Watch / correct: Using rudder alone to hurry the rollout - reduce bank with coordinated aileron and rudder.

Stop / transition: Roll wings level and discontinue if the turn is uncoordinated, traffic appears or the learner loses the altitude/airspeed picture.

Reference: AFH: turns; PHAK: adverse yaw and coordination

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Use the currently effective Sport airplane PTS task, which specifies the near-stall condition at which another increase in angle of attack/load or reduction in power would produce an immediate stall. Clear, choose a safe recovery floor that permits completion at or above the PTS minimum of 1,500 feet AGL, and follow all aircraft limitations. Demonstrate coordinated straight flight, gentle turns, climb and descent with the requested approved configurations, then recover to cruise. This Sport task differs from the private-certificate slow-flight condition.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One entry, two shallow turns and one recovery; repeat the entry only after identifying the largest error.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Recognize and recover at the first stall indication · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Demonstrate one approach-type and one departure-type entry in the approved aircraft configuration. Name the cues as they appear. Recover at the first stall indication by reducing angle of attack and using the POH recovery sequence; do not continue to a full stall in this exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Clear, set the configuration and verify the recovery floor. 2. Enter the instructor-briefed approach scenario. 3. Call the first stall cue and begin recovery immediately. 4. Re-establish stable flight. 5. Repeat for a departure scenario, staying coordinated throughout.

Practice: One instructor example of each entry; one student recovery of each if readiness and altitude allow.

Look for: Names the warning cues and reduces angle of attack without delay; assisted recovery is acceptable on the introduction lesson.

Watch / correct: Trying to climb out by pulling - reduce angle of attack first, then apply approved power.

Watch / correct: Applying aileron aggressively with yaw present - restore coordination and follow the POH stall recovery.

Stop / transition: Instructor intervenes before an uncoordinated stall or spin tendency; recover by the agreed altitude. This lesson does not authorize intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: stall recognition and prevention; POH: stall recovery

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

Debrief - 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Repeat or carry forward

- Recognize and recover at the first stall indication: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- An unobserved, unsafe or below-standard source requirement must be completed in continued training/assessment before progress; the target duration grants no completion credit.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 24

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 25

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 26

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segments 1-7

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 7 - source page 16 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 8 · Performance preparation

Use the actual aircraft manual for speeds, configuration limits and performance before full-stall/steep-turn practice.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Use the actual aircraft manual for speeds, configuration limits and performance before full-stall/steep-turn practice.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segments 10, 19-21

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 1

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 7

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 9 · Full stalls and steep-turn introduction

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-30 Air 08-22	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
30-44 Air 22-36	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
44-58 Air 36-50	[] Steep turns in both directions	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 9

Progress from warning recognition to coordinated full-stall recovery in approved flap configurations, then introduce the steeper-bank control picture.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Progress from warning recognition to coordinated full-stall recovery in approved flap configurations, then introduce the steeper-bank control picture.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario; Steep turns in both directions.
- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: From a safe altitude, show an approach-type full stall with coordinated controls. Identify the first warning and the full-stall indication, then reduce angle of attack, add approved power and clean up in the POH sequence. Contrast the entry with and without flaps.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One entry with flaps and one without on introduction; on review add one briefed turning entry only after straight entries are safe.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Demonstrate the approved departure configuration and controlled pitch-up at the briefed power. Show the rudder required as speed decreases. At the full stall, reduce angle of attack, maintain coordination and restore a safe climb according to the POH.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry. The source introduction is without flaps; use that approved configuration rather than adding a flap configuration the lesson has not assigned.

Practice: One straight entry, then the other approved configuration or a shallow turning entry on a review lesson; never rush the reset.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Steep turns in both directions · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show clearing, the current Sport PTS bank target, the added back pressure/power as needed and an outside reference that reveals altitude drift. Demonstrate the rollout and a complete reset before changing direction.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and choose altitude, airspeed and rollout reference. 2. Establish the briefed bank with coordinated controls. 3. Maintain the outside pitch picture and cross-check altitude. 4. Complete the turn, roll out and stabilize. 5. Repeat in the other direction after clearing.

Practice: One demonstration followed by one student turn each way on introduction; two student turns each way on review if safe and unrushed.

Look for: Controls bank, pitch and power without fixation; introductory performance may need coaching, while final assessment uses current Sport PTS tolerances.

Watch / correct: Trying to correct altitude with bank alone - restore the briefed bank and make a small pitch/power correction.

Watch / correct: Looking only inside - return to the outside pitch reference and make short instrument cross-checks.

Stop / transition: Roll out if bank, load, airspeed or altitude approaches an aircraft limit or safe practice boundary; never chase a tolerance through unsafe control inputs.

Reference: AFH: steep turns; Sport PTS: Steep Turns

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Student explains the new exercise and performs its sequence with the assistance appropriate to introduction, followed by a corrected repeat when safe.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segments 7-10

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 3

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 9 - source page 18 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 10 - Weather theory preparation

Connect stability, clouds and hazardous weather to the next flight's conditions and cancellation decisions.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Connect stability, clouds and hazardous weather to the next flight's conditions and cancellation decisions.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segments 7, 8, 17, 18

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 11

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 1

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 2

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 11 · Selected-rate climbs and descents, with maneuver review

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-28 Air 08-20	[] Selected-rate climbs and descents	1.
28-36 Air 20-28	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
36-44 Air 28-36	[] Steep turns in both directions	1.
44-51 Air 36-43	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
51-58 Air 43-50	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 11

Introduce vertical-rate targets after constant-airspeed control is understood. Review slow flight, full stalls and steep turns with a stable reset between tasks.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Introduce vertical-rate targets after constant-airspeed control is understood. Review slow flight, full stalls and steep turns with a stable reset between tasks.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Constant-airspeed and constant-rate altitude changes; Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Steep turns in both directions; Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario.
- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Selected-rate climbs and descents · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Introduce a selected vertical-rate climb/descent using aircraft-appropriate pitch/power while protecting airspeed. Demonstrate how to avoid chasing a lagging rate indication and how to anticipate level-off. Return control for both directions and require a small, stable correction.

Student exercise: 1. Brief the rate, altitude and safe airspeed range. 2. Establish the selected-rate climb. 3. Cross-check airspeed/altitude with rate and altitude. 4. Lead the level-off. 5. Repeat in descent and explain when a rate target must be abandoned for airspeed/safety.

Practice: One instructor example, then one student selected-rate climb and one descent with level-offs.

Look for: Selects the proper pitch/power combination, anticipates level-off and corrects a trend before it becomes a large deviation.

Watch / correct: Fixating on rate while airspeed decays - restore a safe pitch/airspeed and reduce the rate target.

Watch / correct: Leveling late - announce the approaching altitude and begin the transition earlier.

Stop / transition: Level off or restore cruise if assigned airspace, terrain clearance or an airspeed/configuration limit would be approached.

Reference: AFH: climbs and descents; PHAK: instruments

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Use the currently effective Sport airplane PTS task, which specifies the near-stall condition at which another increase in angle of attack/load or reduction in power would produce an immediate stall. Clear, choose a safe recovery floor that permits completion at or above the PTS minimum of 1,500 feet AGL, and follow all aircraft limitations. Demonstrate coordinated straight flight, gentle turns, climb and descent with the requested approved configurations, then recover to cruise. This Sport task differs from the private-certificate slow-flight condition.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One entry, two shallow turns and one recovery; repeat the entry only after identifying the largest error.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Steep turns in both directions · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Show clearing, the current Sport PTS bank target, the added back pressure/power as needed and an outside reference that reveals altitude drift. Demonstrate the rollout and a complete reset before changing direction.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and choose altitude, airspeed and rollout reference. 2. Establish the briefed bank with coordinated controls. 3. Maintain the outside pitch picture and cross-check altitude. 4. Complete the turn, roll out and stabilize. 5. Repeat in the other direction after clearing.

Practice: One demonstration followed by one student turn each way on introduction; two student turns each way on review if safe and unrushed.

Look for: Controls bank, pitch and power without fixation; introductory performance may need coaching, while final assessment uses current Sport PTS tolerances.

Watch / correct: Trying to correct altitude with bank alone - restore the briefed bank and make a small pitch/power correction.

Watch / correct: Looking only inside - return to the outside pitch reference and make short instrument cross-checks.

Stop / transition: Roll out if bank, load, airspeed or altitude approaches an aircraft limit or safe practice boundary; never chase a tolerance through unsafe control inputs.

Reference: AFH: steep turns; Sport PTS: Steep Turns

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: From a safe altitude, show an approach-type full stall with coordinated controls. Identify the first warning and the full-stall indication, then reduce angle of attack, add approved power and clean up in the POH sequence. Contrast the entry with and without flaps.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One entry with flaps and one without on introduction; on review add one briefed turning entry only after straight entries are safe.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Demonstrate the approved departure configuration and controlled pitch-up at the briefed power. Show the rudder required as speed decreases. At the full stall, reduce angle of attack, maintain coordination and restore a safe climb according to the POH.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry.

Practice: One straight entry, then the other approved configuration or a shallow turning entry on a review lesson; never rush the reset.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 19

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segments 1-11

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 3

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 11 - source page 20 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 12 · Weather reports and forecasts

Interpret current weather products and build a flight-specific briefing before ground-reference training.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Interpret current weather products and build a flight-specific briefing before ground-reference training.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segments 11-13, 22, 23](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 11](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 3](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 13](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 14](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 13 · Wind correction and ground-reference introduction

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-21 Air 08-13	[] Read the wind before ground-reference maneuvers	1.
21-33 Air 13-25	[] Rectangular course: wind correction by leg	1.
33-45 Air 25-37	[] S-turns across a road	1.
45-58 Air 37-50	[] Turns around a point	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 13

Teach heading versus ground track, then apply changing bank and drift correction to a rectangle, S-turns and turns around a point.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Teach heading versus ground track, then apply changing bank and drift correction to a rectangle, S-turns and turns around a point.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Read the wind before ground-reference maneuvers; Rectangular course: wind correction by leg; S-turns across a road; Turns around a point.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Read the wind before ground-reference maneuvers · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Use a road or field boundary to compare heading with actual ground track. Show how groundspeed changes around a point and why the bank changes through a maneuver. Select a legal, clear practice area with escape options.

Student exercise: 1. Identify wind direction from available evidence. 2. Compare heading and ground track on two headings. 3. Explain where groundspeed and required bank will be greatest. 4. Select the reference, practice altitude and emergency options before maneuvering.

Practice: Two short wind comparisons, then a verbal prediction before the first ground-reference entry.

Look for: Predicts drift and varying groundspeed and chooses a reference that permits safe, legal maneuvering.

Watch / correct: Assuming heading equals track - compare the airplane with a fixed ground feature.

Watch / correct: Selecting a feature near people or obstacles - choose another area before descending.

Stop / transition: Do not enter if terrain, obstructions, populated areas, airspace or traffic cannot support safe practice at the chosen altitude.

Reference: AFH: ground-reference maneuvers; PHAK: wind correction

Rectangular course: wind correction by leg · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Demonstrate downwind entry, planned lateral spacing and changing bank through each corner. Point out crab on crosswind legs and the difference between heading and track; keep the selected altitude and an outside scan.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and establish the briefed entry. 2. Hold parallel ground tracks with wind correction. 3. Change bank smoothly through each corner to preserve spacing. 4. Call the wind correction on each leg. 5. Exit without descending or tightening toward obstacles.

Practice: One instructor circuit and one student circuit on introduction; two student circuits on review if time allows.

Look for: Maintains safe altitude and reasonably uniform spacing, predicts drift and changes bank smoothly rather than skidding the turn.

Watch / correct: Turning too late on the fast downwind corner - anticipate the corner and use an appropriate coordinated bank.

Watch / correct: Looking continuously at the field - alternate the reference with traffic, horizon and altitude scans.

Stop / transition: Exit toward a safe area for traffic, inadequate obstacle clearance, excessive bank or an unstable altitude trend.

Reference: AFH: rectangular course; Sport PTS: Ground Reference Maneuvers

S-turns across a road · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show a suitable reference line, an entry perpendicular to it and changing bank with groundspeed. Demonstrate a wings-level crossing before reversing the turn; explain why equal-looking ground arcs need unequal banks.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and approach the reference as briefed. 2. Begin a coordinated turn that compensates for the wind. 3. Cross wings level and reverse the turn. 4. Adjust bank to create the second comparable arc. 5. Exit and describe the strongest drift correction.

Practice: One paired S-turn demonstration and one student pair on introduction; two student pairs on review.

Look for: Crosses the reference with wings approximately level, varies bank with wind and preserves altitude and coordination.

Watch / correct: Holding one bank all the way around - anticipate changing groundspeed and vary bank.

Watch / correct: Rushing the reversal with rudder - level the wings at the reference, then enter the opposite bank together.

Stop / transition: Exit if bank/altitude trend is unsafe or the chosen road has traffic/obstructions that compromise the practice area; maintain legal clearances.

Reference: AFH: S-turns; Sport PTS: Ground Reference Maneuvers

Turns around a point - 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Select a visible point with clear surrounding airspace. Demonstrate entry and variable bank to hold a constant radius as groundspeed changes. Explain the steepest-bank sector and the need to retain an escape route.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and choose a safe radius and altitude. 2. Enter as briefed. 3. Adjust bank to maintain the ground radius. 4. Keep the ball centered and scan outside. 5. Exit after a full circuit and predict corrections for a second direction.

Practice: One instructor circuit and one student circuit on introduction; one student circuit each way on review.

Look for: Holds a consistent radius using coordinated bank changes, with safe altitude and a sustained traffic scan.

Watch / correct: Tightening toward the point when blown inward - reduce bank and re-establish the planned radius.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the point - scan the horizon and traffic, then check the ground reference briefly.

Stop / transition: Leave the maneuver if the required bank exceeds the practice limit, an escape route is compromised or traffic/terrain clearance becomes uncertain.

Reference: AFH: turns around a point; Sport PTS: Ground Reference Maneuvers

Return, stabilized approach and final landing - 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Student explains the new exercise and performs its sequence with the assistance appropriate to introduction, followed by a corrected repeat when safe.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segment 1

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 1

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 13 - source page 22 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 14 · Weather products and sources

Interpret current weather reports, forecasts and briefing sources before the next flight; bring a route-specific go/no-go decision and questions.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Interpret current weather reports, forecasts and briefing sources before the next flight; bring a route-specific go/no-go decision and questions.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 17](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 18](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 11](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 2](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 14](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 15](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 15 · Wind-track and maneuver consolidation

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-25 Air 08-17	[] Rectangular course: wind correction by leg	1.
25-34 Air 17-26	[] S-turns across a road	1.
34-42 Air 26-34	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
42-50 Air 34-42	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
50-58 Air 42-50	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 15

Review rectangle/S-turn ground tracks, both full-stall types, slow flight and steep turns. Revisit turns around a point if the source completion requirement has not already been demonstrated.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Review rectangle/S-turn ground tracks, both full-stall types, slow flight and steep turns. Revisit turns around a point if the source completion requirement has not already been demonstrated.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Rectangular course: wind correction by leg; S-turns across a road; Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario.
- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Rectangular course: wind correction by leg · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Demonstrate downwind entry, planned lateral spacing and changing bank through each corner. Point out crab on crosswind legs and the difference between heading and track; keep the selected altitude and an outside scan.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and establish the briefed entry. 2. Hold parallel ground tracks with wind correction. 3. Change bank smoothly through each corner to preserve spacing. 4. Call the wind correction on each leg. 5. Exit without descending or tightening toward obstacles.

Practice: One instructor circuit and one student circuit on introduction; two student circuits on review if time allows.

Look for: Maintains safe altitude and reasonably uniform spacing, predicts drift and changes bank smoothly rather than skidding the turn.

Watch / correct: Turning too late on the fast downwind corner - anticipate the corner and use an appropriate coordinated bank.

Watch / correct: Looking continuously at the field - alternate the reference with traffic, horizon and altitude scans.

Stop / transition: Exit toward a safe area for traffic, inadequate obstacle clearance, excessive bank or an unstable altitude trend.

Reference: AFH: rectangular course; Sport PTS: Ground Reference Maneuvers

S-turns across a road • 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Show a suitable reference line, an entry perpendicular to it and changing bank with groundspeed. Demonstrate a wings-level crossing before reversing the turn; explain why equal-looking ground arcs need unequal banks.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and approach the reference as briefed. 2. Begin a coordinated turn that compensates for the wind. 3. Cross wings level and reverse the turn. 4. Adjust bank to create the second comparable arc. 5. Exit and describe the strongest drift correction.

Practice: One paired S-turn demonstration and one student pair on introduction; two student pairs on review.

Look for: Crosses the reference with wings approximately level, varies bank with wind and preserves altitude and coordination.

Watch / correct: Holding one bank all the way around - anticipate changing groundspeed and vary bank.

Watch / correct: Rushing the reversal with rudder - level the wings at the reference, then enter the opposite bank together.

Stop / transition: Exit if bank/altitude trend is unsafe or the chosen road has traffic/obstructions that compromise the practice area; maintain legal clearances.

Reference: AFH: S-turns; Sport PTS: Ground Reference Maneuvers

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit • 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Use the currently effective Sport airplane PTS task, which specifies the near-stall condition at which another increase in angle of attack/load or reduction in power would produce an immediate stall. Clear, choose a safe recovery floor that permits completion at or above the PTS minimum of 1,500 feet AGL, and follow all aircraft limitations. Demonstrate coordinated straight flight, gentle turns, climb and descent with the requested approved configurations, then recover to cruise. This Sport task differs from the private-certificate slow-flight condition.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One entry, two shallow turns and one recovery; repeat the entry only after identifying the largest error.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: From a safe altitude, show an approach-type full stall with coordinated controls. Identify the first warning and the full-stall indication, then reduce angle of attack, add approved power and clean up in the POH sequence. Contrast the entry with and without flaps.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One entry with flaps and one without on introduction; on review add one briefed turning entry only after straight entries are safe.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Demonstrate the approved departure configuration and controlled pitch-up at the briefed power. Show the rudder required as speed decreases. At the full stall, reduce angle of attack, maintain coordination and restore a safe climb according to the POH.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry.

Practice: One straight entry, then the other approved configuration or a shallow turning entry on a review lesson; never rush the reset.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Repeat or carry forward

- Steep turns in both directions: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Turns around a point: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- The source completion text also expects turns around a point, although that task is absent from this lesson's content checklist. Confirm prior evidence or schedule a dedicated turn-around-point review before completion.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 3

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 15

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 15 - source page 24 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 16 · Emergency preparation

Locate the aircraft emergency procedures and rehearse control-first priorities before simulated failures.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Locate the aircraft emergency procedures and rehearse control-first priorities before simulated failures.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 5](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 6](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 17 · Reject, go around and handle an abnormal situation

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-22 Air 08-14	[] Rejected-takeoff decision and controlled simulation	1.
22-32 Air 14-24	[] Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action	1.
32-48 Air 24-40	[] Simulated engine failure and emergency approach	1.
48-58 Air 40-50	[] Go-around from a rejected landing	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 17

Build early decisions and an orderly response to equipment problems or simulated engine failure. Brief all simulations before movement and preserve actual aircraft systems.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Build early decisions and an orderly response to equipment problems or simulated engine failure. Brief all simulations before movement and preserve actual aircraft systems.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Rejected-takeoff decision and controlled simulation; Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action; Simulated engine failure and emergency approach; Go-around from a rejected landing.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Rejected-takeoff decision and controlled simulation · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Before moving, brief rejection triggers, runway remaining and the aircraft stopping procedure. Demonstrate a reject only in an instructor-selected, prebriefed low-risk condition with adequate runway; otherwise use a stopped/verbal scenario and schedule the flight task later.

Student exercise: 1. State what would require rejection before the roll. 2. Keep directional control during the authorized simulation. 3. Reduce power and stop using the POH procedure. 4. Communicate and clear the runway when safe. 5. Explain why continuing would be unsafe.

Practice: One coached decision rehearsal and, only when suitable, one prebriefed controlled reject. No unannounced high-speed abort.

Look for: Recognizes a rejection trigger promptly and preserves runway alignment while stopping with adequate margin.

Watch / correct: Continuing because the instructor has not spoken - act on the briefed rejection trigger.

Watch / correct: Braking aggressively while drifting - maintain directional control and apply the approved stopping procedure.

Stop / transition: Do not simulate if runway, traffic, contamination or aircraft condition reduces stopping margin. A verbal rehearsal does not count as a completed flight task.

Reference: AFH: takeoffs and emergency procedures; aircraft POH

Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Use a verbal or approved simulated indication, such as an electrical or instrument fault. Show how to preserve aircraft control, confirm the indication, use the correct checklist and decide whether to land or divert. Do not disable essential equipment.

Student exercise: 1. Identify the abnormal indication. 2. Keep flying and state the immediate risk. 3. Apply only approved memory actions when applicable, then use the checklist. 4. Reassess systems, weather and landing options. 5. Tell the instructor/ATC what help is needed.

Practice: Two contrasting verbal scenarios, one with a land-soon decision and one requiring checklist diagnosis.

Look for: Prioritizes aircraft control, chooses the correct checklist and reaches a defensible landing/diversion decision without random switch changes.

Watch / correct: Treating the indication before controlling the airplane - restore control, then diagnose.

Watch / correct: Resetting a breaker or moving a control without authority - consult the aircraft checklist and identify the consequence first.

Stop / transition: End the simulation immediately for a real abnormality, distraction from traffic/terrain or any effect on essential equipment.

Reference: AFH: emergency procedures; POH: systems and abnormal checklists

Simulated engine failure and emergency approach · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Brief how the simulation will start, the minimum recovery condition and who controls power. Demonstrate airspeed, landing-site choice and a plan to the site. Use checklist/communications only after control and the landing plan are established.

Student exercise: 1. Establish the POH glide condition. 2. Select a reachable suitable site and plan the approach. 3. Perform approved checklist actions or verbalize unsafe-to-simulate actions. 4. Brief occupants and communications. 5. Evaluate whether the site remains reachable, then recover at the briefed gate.

Practice: One instructor example on introduction and one student scenario; repeat with a different site only with sufficient altitude and time.

Look for: Maintains glide control, selects a reachable site early and manages checklist/communications without losing the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Searching indefinitely for the perfect field - select a suitable reachable option and refine it.

Watch / correct: Trying to stretch the glide - maintain the POH glide condition and revise the landing plan.

Stop / transition: Recover with power at the prebriefed safe altitude/position or earlier for traffic, terrain, a poor glide plan or aircraft concerns. No surprise engine shutdown or off-airport touchdown.

Reference: AFH: emergency approach; Sport PTS: Emergency Approach and Landing; POH

Go-around from a rejected landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Brief the unstable-approach gate and demonstrate an early decision to go around. Show approved power, pitch, configuration changes and runway/traffic tracking. Explain why cleaning up before a safe climb can increase sink.

Student exercise: 1. Identify the assigned unstable-approach cue. 2. Announce and initiate the go-around promptly. 3. Apply approved power and establish the climb attitude. 4. Change configuration in the POH sequence. 5. Maintain runway/traffic separation and communicate when workload allows.

Practice: One demonstration on introduction and one student go-around; on review one planned and one student-initiated decision when safe.

Look for: Makes the decision early, controls yaw/pitch and transitions to a safe climb without premature configuration changes.

Watch / correct: Waiting to see whether the landing improves - use the briefed gate and commit to a go-around.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps while still descending - establish the approved climb and configuration sequence.

Stop / transition: Instructor intervenes for a stall tendency, conflict or runway misalignment; do not manufacture an unsafe approach to create a go-around.

Reference: AFH: approaches and go-arounds; Sport PTS: Go-Around/Rejected Landing

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Student explains the new exercise and performs its sequence with the assistance appropriate to introduction, followed by a corrected repeat when safe.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segments 11-15

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 4

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 15

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 17 - source page 26 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 18 · Rules, ACS and logbook preparation

Connect applicable regulations, operating guidance and logbook/endorsement rules to the next flights.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Connect applicable regulations, operating guidance and logbook/endorsement rules to the next flights.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 1](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 2](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 24](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 25](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 6: Segment 1](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 19 · Crosswind control, slips and no-flap landing

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-32 Air 08-24	[] Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing	1.
32-40 Air 24-32	[] Sideslip and forward slip: distinct purposes	1.
40-50 Air 32-42	[] Forward slip to a stabilized landing	1.
50-58 Air 42-50	[] Landing without flaps	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 19

Compare crab and sideslip methods, distinguish sideslip from forward slip and practice an approved no-flap approach. Weather and aircraft restrictions decide which methods are demonstrated.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Compare crab and sideslip methods, distinguish sideslip from forward slip and practice an approved no-flap approach. Weather and aircraft restrictions decide which methods are demonstrated.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing; Sideslip and forward slip: distinct purposes; Forward slip to a stabilized landing; Landing without flaps.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show the wind correction on taxi, takeoff roll and climb. In the pattern compare a crab on approach with a sideslip that aligns the longitudinal axis at touchdown. Explain which method/transition the aircraft permits and the crosswind limits selected for this lesson.

Student exercise: 1. Identify wind and select the briefed technique. 2. Hold runway alignment during takeoff with coordinated controls. 3. Correct drift in the climb. 4. Fly a stabilized approach. 5. Remove drift and align the airplane using the approved method; go around if control margin is inadequate.

Practice: One demonstrated circuit and one student circuit on introduction; add a second student landing only within weather and time limits.

Look for: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance.

Watch / correct: Holding a fixed correction as airspeed changes - adjust control continuously for the changing effectiveness.

Watch / correct: Touching down while drifting or crabbed beyond aircraft guidance - go around and reset the approach.

Stop / transition: Go around for excessive drift, misalignment, gusts or inadequate control margin. Use aircraft, instructor and endorsement limits; a published demonstrated crosswind is not automatically a legal operating limit.

Reference: AFH: crosswind takeoffs and landings; POH

Sideslip and forward slip: distinct purposes · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: At a safe altitude, demonstrate a sideslip to correct drift while tracking a line, then a forward slip to increase descent with a chosen track. Show approved configuration and indications; compare control inputs and how to return smoothly to coordinated flight.

Student exercise: 1. Verify the aircraft permits the selected slip/configuration. 2. Establish a briefed sideslip and state its drift-control purpose. 3. Return to coordinated flight. 4. Establish a forward slip while holding the planned ground track. 5. Recover before the briefed altitude and explain the difference.

Practice: One instructor example and one student entry of each slip; later approach application requires a separate stabilized-landing exercise.

Look for: Distinguishes drift correction from descent control, stays within aircraft limits and recovers without abrupt yaw or pitch changes.

Watch / correct: Skidding instead of slipping - reduce the control input and have the instructor restore the correct combination.

Watch / correct: Trusting an affected airspeed indication without context - use the POH cautions and the briefed pitch/configuration.

Stop / transition: Discontinue for an aircraft restriction, unapproved flap configuration, unstable speed/track or inadequate recovery height. No slip outside POH guidance.

Reference: AFH: slips; POH: operating limitations and approved procedures

Forward slip to a stabilized landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show when a forward slip can correct excess height on an otherwise safe approach. Establish the approved slip/configuration, preserve the planned track and remove the slip early enough to judge a stabilized touchdown.

Student exercise: 1. Identify excess height and confirm the slip is appropriate. 2. Apply the approved forward-slip technique. 3. Hold the landing track and monitor the POH airspeed cautions. 4. Recover to the required landing alignment. 5. Land only if the final approach is stable; otherwise go around.

Practice: One demonstrated approach on introduction and one student approach; do not repeatedly salvage an unstable approach.

Look for: Uses the slip deliberately, exits smoothly and chooses a go-around if a normal safe touchdown is no longer assured.

Watch / correct: Slipping merely to rescue a rushed approach - go around and rebuild the pattern.

Watch / correct: Recovering the slip too late - use the prebriefed stabilization gate and restore alignment earlier.

Stop / transition: Go around for unapproved configuration, excessive sink/drift, uncertainty about airspeed or failure to stabilize before the aircraft/instructor gate.

Reference: AFH: forward slip to landing; Sport PTS: Forward Slip to a Landing; POH

Landing without flaps · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Brief the aircraft-approved no-flap approach speed, runway performance and altered sight picture. Demonstrate planning the pattern for the lower drag and avoiding a late, steep correction.

Student exercise: 1. Confirm no-flap performance and runway margin from the POH. 2. Set the approved approach configuration and speed. 3. Judge the higher energy and adjusted descent path. 4. Stabilize and align the aircraft. 5. Land or go around before excess speed/height threatens runway margin.

Practice: One demonstration on introduction and one student no-flap landing when runway and traffic permit.

Look for: Plans the approach early, controls energy and touches down with adequate runway remaining without forcing the airplane onto the runway.

Watch / correct: Using the usual flap-landing picture and arriving fast - adjust pattern and energy earlier.

Watch / correct: Diving to the aiming point - go around and plan a stable descent.

Stop / transition: Go around if approach energy, alignment or remaining runway becomes uncertain; do not simulate a flap failure by creating an actual system fault.

Reference: AFH: no-flap approach; POH: configuration and landing performance

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Student explains the new exercise and performs its sequence with the assistance appropriate to introduction, followed by a corrected repeat when safe.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Repeat or carry forward

- Rejected-takeoff decision and controlled simulation: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Go-around from a rejected landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segment 13

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segments 1-4

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 19 - source page 28 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 20 - Aircraft systems preparation I

Use the actual aircraft systems diagrams and POH to explain engine, fuel and electrical operations.

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Ground preparation objectives

- Use the actual aircraft systems diagrams and POH to explain engine, fuel and electrical operations.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 4](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 10](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 26](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 21 · Low-speed and crosswind proficiency

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-28 Air 08-20	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
28-38 Air 20-30	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
38-48 Air 30-40	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
48-58 Air 40-50	[] Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 21

Review slow flight and departure-type stall recovery, then develop consistent crosswind takeoff/landing control. Use only approved configurations and conditions within the instructor's selected limits.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Review slow flight and departure-type stall recovery, then develop consistent crosswind takeoff/landing control. Use only approved configurations and conditions within the instructor's selected limits.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario; Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing.
- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Use the currently effective Sport airplane PTS task, which specifies the near-stall condition at which another increase in angle of attack/load or reduction in power would produce an immediate stall. Clear, choose a safe recovery floor that permits completion at or above the PTS minimum of 1,500 feet AGL, and follow all aircraft limitations. Demonstrate coordinated straight flight, gentle turns, climb and descent with the requested approved configurations, then recover to cruise. This Sport task differs from the private-certificate slow-flight condition.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One entry, two shallow turns and one recovery; repeat the entry only after identifying the largest error.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: From a safe altitude, show an approach-type full stall with coordinated controls. Identify the first warning and the full-stall indication, then reduce angle of attack, add approved power and clean up in the POH sequence. Contrast the entry with and without flaps.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One entry with flaps and one without on introduction; on review add one briefed turning entry only after straight entries are safe.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Demonstrate the approved departure configuration and controlled pitch-up at the briefed power. Show the rudder required as speed decreases. At the full stall, reduce angle of attack, maintain coordination and restore a safe climb according to the POH.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry.

Practice: One straight entry, then the other approved configuration or a shallow turning entry on a review lesson; never rush the reset.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Show the wind correction on taxi, takeoff roll and climb. In the pattern compare a crab on approach with a sideslip that aligns the longitudinal axis at touchdown. Explain which method/transition the aircraft permits and the crosswind limits selected for this lesson.

Student exercise: 1. Identify wind and select the briefed technique. 2. Hold runway alignment during takeoff with coordinated controls. 3. Correct drift in the climb. 4. Fly a stabilized approach. 5. Remove drift and align the airplane using the approved method; go around if control margin is inadequate.

Practice: One demonstrated circuit and one student circuit on introduction; add a second student landing only within weather and time limits.

Look for: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance.

Watch / correct: Holding a fixed correction as airspeed changes - adjust control continuously for the changing effectiveness.

Watch / correct: Touching down while drifting or crabbed beyond aircraft guidance - go around and reset the approach.

Stop / transition: Go around for excessive drift, misalignment, gusts or inadequate control margin. Use aircraft, instructor and endorsement limits; a published demonstrated crosswind is not automatically a legal operating limit.

Reference: AFH: crosswind takeoffs and landings; POH

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.

- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.

- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 21 - source page 30 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 22 · Aircraft systems preparation II

Review instruments and avionics limitations and explain what indications would reveal a failure.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Review instruments and avionics limitations and explain what indications would reveal a failure.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 8](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 9](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segment 3](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Segment 4](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 23 · Presolo landing rehearsal

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-28 Air 08-20	[] Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing	1.
28-38 Air 20-30	[] Forward slip to a stabilized landing	1.
38-48 Air 30-40	[] Landing without flaps	1.
48-58 Air 40-50	[] Go-around from a rejected landing	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 23

Build repeatable patterns, crosswind decisions, slips, no-flap landing and go-around judgment. Use a normal landing between changed configurations when the student needs a reset.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Build repeatable patterns, crosswind decisions, slips, no-flap landing and go-around judgment. Use a normal landing between changed configurations when the student needs a reset.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Prepare an independent plan of action and identify required tasks not yet safely demonstrated.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing; Forward slip to a stabilized landing; Landing without flaps; Go-around from a rejected landing.
- State the assessment rules: no coaching during the independent attempt, safety intervention is documented, and all unobserved/deficient required tasks need continued training or assessment. Stage I determines safe

solo readiness; the final check uses the current Sport PTS.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe student-led surface operations without prompting; safety intervention means further training is needed. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe an independent departure and traffic scan; give only task/route instructions. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify wind and select the briefed technique. 2. Hold runway alignment during takeoff with coordinated controls. 3. Correct drift in the climb. 4. Fly a stabilized approach. 5. Remove drift and align the airplane using the approved method; go around if control margin is inadequate.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance.

Watch / correct: Holding a fixed correction as airspeed changes - adjust control continuously for the changing effectiveness.

Watch / correct: Touching down while drifting or crabbed beyond aircraft guidance - go around and reset the approach.

Stop / transition: Go around for excessive drift, misalignment, gusts or inadequate control margin. Use aircraft, instructor and endorsement limits; a published demonstrated crosswind is not automatically a legal operating limit.

Reference: AFH: crosswind takeoffs and landings; POH

Forward slip to a stabilized landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Uses the slip deliberately, exits smoothly and chooses a go-around if a normal safe touchdown is no longer assured. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify excess height and confirm the slip is appropriate. 2. Apply the approved forward-slip technique. 3. Hold the landing track and monitor the POH airspeed cautions. 4. Recover to the required landing alignment. 5. Land only if the final approach is stable; otherwise go around.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Uses the slip deliberately, exits smoothly and chooses a go-around if a normal safe touchdown is no longer assured.

Watch / correct: Slipping merely to rescue a rushed approach - go around and rebuild the pattern.

Watch / correct: Recovering the slip too late - use the prebriefed stabilization gate and restore alignment earlier.

Stop / transition: Go around for unapproved configuration, excessive sink/drift, uncertainty about airspeed or failure to stabilize before the aircraft/instructor gate.

Reference: AFH: forward slip to landing; Sport PTS: Forward Slip to a Landing; POH

Landing without flaps · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Plans the approach early, controls energy and touches down with adequate runway remaining without forcing the airplane onto the runway. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Confirm no-flap performance and runway margin from the POH. 2. Set the approved approach configuration and speed. 3. Judge the higher energy and adjusted descent path. 4. Stabilize and align the aircraft. 5. Land or go around before excess speed/height threatens runway margin.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Plans the approach early, controls energy and touches down with adequate runway remaining without forcing the airplane onto the runway.

Watch / correct: Using the usual flap-landing picture and arriving fast - adjust pattern and energy earlier.

Watch / correct: Diving to the aiming point - go around and plan a stable descent.

Stop / transition: Go around if approach energy, alignment or remaining runway becomes uncertain; do not simulate a flap failure by creating an actual system fault.

Reference: AFH: no-flap approach; POH: configuration and landing performance

Go-around from a rejected landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Makes the decision early, controls yaw/pitch and transitions to a safe climb without premature configuration changes. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify the assigned unstable-approach cue. 2. Announce and initiate the go-around promptly. 3. Apply approved power and establish the climb attitude. 4. Change configuration in the POH sequence. 5. Maintain runway/traffic separation and communicate when workload allows.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Makes the decision early, controls yaw/pitch and transitions to a safe climb without premature configuration changes.

Watch / correct: Waiting to see whether the landing improves - use the briefed gate and commit to a go-around.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps while still descending - establish the approved climb and configuration sequence.

Stop / transition: Instructor intervenes for a stall tendency, conflict or runway misalignment; do not manufacture an unsafe approach to create a go-around.

Reference: AFH: approaches and go-arounds; Sport PTS: Go-Around/Rejected Landing

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess an independent arrival and landing; provide safety intervention if needed and record it. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Solo readiness requires satisfactory presolo knowledge/corrections, required logged training and consistently safe patterns, landing control and emergency decisions in the intended aircraft. Further coaching to prevent an unsafe outcome means further dual training.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Review Segments as Needed

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 23 - source page 32 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 24 · Systems, instruments and maintenance

Connect instrument indications, maintenance status and pilot responsibilities to presolo readiness.

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Ground preparation objectives

- Connect instrument indications, maintenance status and pilot responsibilities to presolo readiness.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Segment 6](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 9](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 14](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 8](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 25 · Presolo knowledge test and flight rehearsal

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-22 Air 08-14	[] Sight picture, climb, level flight and descent	1.
22-26 Air 14-18	[] Coordinated turns to headings	1.
26-32 Air 18-24	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
32-38 Air 24-30	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
38-44 Air 30-36	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
44-49 Air 36-41	[] Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action	1.
49-58 Air 41-50	[] Simulated engine failure and emergency approach	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 25

Administer the aircraft/airport/rules presolo test and review every incorrect answer before any solo authorization. Fly a rehearsal emphasizing independent control and a safe emergency landing plan.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Administer the aircraft/airport/rules presolo test and review every incorrect answer before any solo authorization. Fly a rehearsal emphasizing independent control and a safe emergency landing plan.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Prepare an independent plan of action and identify required tasks not yet safely demonstrated.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Sight picture, climb, level flight and descent; Coordinated turns to headings; Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario; Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action; Simulated engine failure and emergency approach.

- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.
- State the assessment rules: no coaching during the independent attempt, safety intervention is documented, and all unobserved/deficient required tasks need continued training or assessment. Stage I determines safe solo readiness; the final check uses the current Sport PTS.
- Administer the presolo aircraft/rules/local-airspace knowledge test, grade it and review every wrong answer before any solo authorization. Extend the 30-minute source discussion when the test/corrections require it.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe student-led surface operations without prompting; safety intervention means further training is needed. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe an independent departure and traffic scan; give only task/route instructions. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Sight picture, climb, level flight and descent · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Recognizes the changing sight picture, coordinates pitch and power and levels with timely coaching; initial-flight assistance is expected. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Describe the outside attitude and cross-check the instruments. 2. Hold straight flight with coordinated rudder. 3. Establish the briefed climb airspeed and level at the assigned altitude. 4. Establish a descent, then restore level flight. 5. State what pitch and power changed.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Recognizes the changing sight picture, coordinates pitch and power and levels with timely coaching; initial-flight assistance is expected.

Watch / correct: Chasing the vertical-speed indication - return eyes to the horizon and make one small pitch correction.

Watch / correct: Ball displaced during a power change - add the appropriate rudder while keeping wings level.

Stop / transition: Restore ordinary cruise if traffic, turbulence or workload prevents an outside scan; instructor takes control before an unsafe altitude or airspeed develops.

Reference: AFH: basic flight maneuvers; PHAK: flight controls and instruments

Coordinated turns to headings · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains a coordinated turn, identifies altitude drift and rolls out smoothly with decreasing instructor assistance. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Clear toward the turn. 2. Enter the briefed bank with coordinated controls. 3. Maintain the outside pitch picture. 4. Anticipate rollout to the chosen heading. 5. Re-trim only when stable and reverse direction after another clearing scan.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains a coordinated turn, identifies altitude drift and rolls out smoothly with decreasing instructor assistance.

Watch / correct: Staring at the heading instrument - use it briefly and return to the outside reference.

Watch / correct: Using rudder alone to hurry the rollout - reduce bank with coordinated aileron and rudder.

Stop / transition: Roll wings level and discontinue if the turn is uncoordinated, traffic appears or the learner loses the altitude/airspeed picture.

Reference: AFH: turns; PHAK: adverse yaw and coordination

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Prioritizes aircraft control, chooses the correct checklist and reaches a defensible landing/diversion decision without random switch changes. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify the abnormal indication. 2. Keep flying and state the immediate risk. 3. Apply only approved memory actions when applicable, then use the checklist. 4. Reassess systems, weather and landing options. 5. Tell the instructor/ATC what help is needed.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Prioritizes aircraft control, chooses the correct checklist and reaches a defensible landing/diversion decision without random switch changes.

Watch / correct: Treating the indication before controlling the airplane - restore control, then diagnose.

Watch / correct: Resetting a breaker or moving a control without authority - consult the aircraft checklist and identify the consequence first.

Stop / transition: End the simulation immediately for a real abnormality, distraction from traffic/terrain or any effect on essential equipment.

Reference: AFH: emergency procedures; POH: systems and abnormal checklists

Simulated engine failure and emergency approach · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains glide control, selects a reachable site early and manages checklist/communications without losing the landing plan. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Establish the POH glide condition. 2. Select a reachable suitable site and plan the approach. 3. Perform approved checklist actions or verbalize unsafe-to-simulate actions. 4. Brief occupants and communications. 5. Evaluate whether the site remains reachable, then recover at the briefed gate.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains glide control, selects a reachable site early and manages checklist/communications without losing the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Searching indefinitely for the perfect field - select a suitable reachable option and refine it.

Watch / correct: Trying to stretch the glide - maintain the POH glide condition and revise the landing plan.

Stop / transition: Recover with power at the prebriefed safe altitude/position or earlier for traffic, terrain, a poor glide plan or aircraft concerns. No surprise engine shutdown or off-airport touchdown.

Reference: AFH: emergency approach; Sport PTS: Emergency Approach and Landing; POH

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess an independent arrival and landing; provide safety intervention if needed and record it. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Solo readiness requires satisfactory presolo knowledge/corrections, required logged training and consistently safe patterns, landing control and emergency decisions in the intended aircraft. Further coaching to prevent an unsafe outcome means further dual training.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Repeat or carry forward

- Steep turns in both directions: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Sideslip and forward slip: distinct purposes: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Forward slip to a stabilized landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Landing without flaps: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Go-around from a rejected landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- An unobserved, unsafe or below-standard source requirement must be completed in continued training/assessment before progress; the target duration grants no completion credit.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segments 26-28, Review Segments as Needed

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 25 - source page 34 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 26 · Stage I: solo-readiness assessment

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min check | Brief 60 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 30

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-30 Air 08-22	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
30-42 Air 22-34	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
42-54 Air 34-46	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
54-62 Air 46-54	[] Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action	1.
62-76 Air 54-68	[] Simulated engine failure and emergency approach	1.
76-86 Air 68-78	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
86-90 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 26

Assess aircraft preparation, basic control, near-stall/full-stall recovery, emergency decisions and patterns needed for safe solo operation. Use the source stage gate and current FAA safety requirements; a clock does not authorize solo.

Source clarification: The source provides 90 flight minutes and 90 discussion minutes. Schedule the go-around assessment in an extended/continued flight if it cannot be observed safely during the complete pattern sequence; all required tasks must be complete before solo release.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Assess aircraft preparation, basic control, near-stall/full-stall recovery, emergency decisions and patterns needed for safe solo operation. Use the source stage gate and current FAA safety requirements; a clock does not authorize solo.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Prepare an independent plan of action and identify required tasks not yet safely demonstrated.

Parked preflight • 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing • 60 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.

- Preview the ordered exercises: Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario; Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action; Simulated engine failure and emergency approach.
- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.
- State the assessment rules: no coaching during the independent attempt, safety intervention is documented, and all unobserved/deficient required tasks need continued training or assessment. Stage I determines safe solo readiness; the final check uses the current Sport PTS.
- Use the parked oral to assess certificates/eligibility, maintenance/airworthiness records, actual aircraft systems/servicing, checklists, weather, performance and solo limitations. Observe preflight duties rather than accepting memorized answers.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe student-led surface operations without prompting; safety intervention means further training is needed. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe an independent departure and traffic scan; give only task/route instructions. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit • 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario • 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Prioritizes aircraft control, chooses the correct checklist and reaches a defensible landing/diversion decision without random switch changes. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Identify the abnormal indication. 2. Keep flying and state the immediate risk. 3. Apply only approved memory actions when applicable, then use the checklist. 4. Reassess systems, weather and landing options. 5. Tell the instructor/ATC what help is needed.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Prioritizes aircraft control, chooses the correct checklist and reaches a defensible landing/diversion decision without random switch changes.

Watch / correct: Treating the indication before controlling the airplane - restore control, then diagnose.

Watch / correct: Resetting a breaker or moving a control without authority - consult the aircraft checklist and identify the consequence first.

Stop / transition: End the simulation immediately for a real abnormality, distraction from traffic/terrain or any effect on essential equipment.

Reference: AFH: emergency procedures; POH: systems and abnormal checklists

Simulated engine failure and emergency approach · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Maintains glide control, selects a reachable site early and manages checklist/communications without losing the landing plan. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Establish the POH glide condition. 2. Select a reachable suitable site and plan the approach. 3. Perform approved checklist actions or verbalize unsafe-to-simulate actions. 4. Brief occupants and communications. 5. Evaluate whether the site remains reachable, then recover at the briefed gate.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains glide control, selects a reachable site early and manages checklist/communications without losing the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Searching indefinitely for the perfect field - select a suitable reachable option and refine it.

Watch / correct: Trying to stretch the glide - maintain the POH glide condition and revise the landing plan.

Stop / transition: Recover with power at the prebriefed safe altitude/position or earlier for traffic, terrain, a poor glide plan or aircraft concerns. No surprise engine shutdown or off-airport touchdown.

Reference: AFH: emergency approach; Sport PTS: Emergency Approach and Landing; POH

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess an independent arrival and landing; provide safety intervention if needed and record it. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Solo readiness requires satisfactory presolo knowledge/corrections, required logged training and consistently safe patterns, landing control and emergency decisions in the intended aircraft. Further coaching to prevent an unsafe outcome means further dual training.

Debrief · 30 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Repeat or carry forward

- Go-around from a rejected landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- An unobserved, unsafe or below-standard source requirement must be completed in continued training/assessment before progress; the target duration grants no completion credit.

Study and sources

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 26 - source page 36 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 27 · Airspace and Sport privilege preparation

Identify local airspace/entry/weather requirements and the additional training/endorsement conditions needed for any proposed Sport operation.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Identify local airspace/entry/weather requirements and the additional training/endorsement conditions needed for any proposed Sport operation.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 13](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 14](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 6: Segment 3](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 28 · Independent patterns after the Stage I check

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-40 Air 08-32	[] Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing	1.
40-58 Air 32-50	[] Go-around from a rejected landing	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 28

Reduce coaching and let the student make pattern, traffic and go-around decisions. Evaluate each landing as a complete arrival-to-rollout sequence.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Reduce coaching and let the student make pattern, traffic and go-around decisions. Evaluate each landing as a complete arrival-to-rollout sequence.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Prepare an independent plan of action and identify required tasks not yet safely demonstrated.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing; Go-around from a rejected landing.
- State the assessment rules: no coaching during the independent attempt, safety intervention is documented, and all unobserved/deficient required tasks need continued training or assessment. Stage I determines safe

solo readiness; the final check uses the current Sport PTS.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe student-led surface operations without prompting; safety intervention means further training is needed. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe an independent departure and traffic scan; give only task/route instructions. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing · 24 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify wind and select the briefed technique. 2. Hold runway alignment during takeoff with coordinated controls. 3. Correct drift in the climb. 4. Fly a stabilized approach. 5. Remove drift and align the airplane using the approved method; go around if control margin is inadequate.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance.

Watch / correct: Holding a fixed correction as airspeed changes - adjust control continuously for the changing effectiveness.

Watch / correct: Touching down while drifting or crabbed beyond aircraft guidance - go around and reset the approach.

Stop / transition: Go around for excessive drift, misalignment, gusts or inadequate control margin. Use aircraft, instructor and endorsement limits; a published demonstrated crosswind is not automatically a legal operating limit.

Reference: AFH: crosswind takeoffs and landings; POH

Go-around from a rejected landing · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Makes the decision early, controls yaw/pitch and transitions to a safe climb without premature configuration changes. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify the assigned unstable-approach cue. 2. Announce and initiate the go-around promptly. 3. Apply approved power and establish the climb attitude. 4. Change configuration in the POH sequence. 5. Maintain runway/traffic separation and communicate when workload allows.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Makes the decision early, controls yaw/pitch and transitions to a safe climb without premature configuration changes.

Watch / correct: Waiting to see whether the landing improves - use the briefed gate and commit to a go-around.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps while still descending - establish the approved climb and configuration sequence.

Stop / transition: Instructor intervenes for a stall tendency, conflict or runway misalignment; do not manufacture an unsafe approach to create a go-around.

Reference: AFH: approaches and go-arounds; Sport PTS: Go-Around/Rejected Landing

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess an independent arrival and landing; provide safety intervention if needed and record it. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.

- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

- Solo readiness requires satisfactory presolo knowledge/corrections, required logged training and consistently safe patterns, landing control and emergency decisions in the intended aircraft. Further coaching to prevent an unsafe outcome means further dual training.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Review Segments as Needed

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 28 - source page 38 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 29 - Charts and publications preparation

Prepare current sectional, airport and radio information before unfamiliar-airport pilotage training.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Prepare current sectional, airport and radio information before unfamiliar-airport pilotage training.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 4](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 5](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segment 7](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 30 · Final dual confirmation before supervised solo

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-36 Air 08-28	[] Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing	1.
36-42 Air 28-34	[] Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action	1.
42-52 Air 34-44	[] Simulated engine failure and emergency approach	1.
52-58 Air 44-50	[] Go-around from a rejected landing	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 30

Require safe patterns without coaching, plus an independent response to a briefed abnormality and simulated emergency approach. Do not schedule first solo because a lesson number has been reached.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Require safe patterns without coaching, plus an independent response to a briefed abnormality and simulated emergency approach. Do not schedule first solo because a lesson number has been reached.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Prepare an independent plan of action and identify required tasks not yet safely demonstrated.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing; Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action; Simulated engine failure and emergency approach; Go-around from a rejected landing.

- State the assessment rules: no coaching during the independent attempt, safety intervention is documented, and all unobserved/deficient required tasks need continued training or assessment. Stage I determines safe solo readiness; the final check uses the current Sport PTS.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe student-led surface operations without prompting; safety intervention means further training is needed. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe an independent departure and traffic scan; give only task/route instructions. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify wind and select the briefed technique. 2. Hold runway alignment during takeoff with coordinated controls. 3. Correct drift in the climb. 4. Fly a stabilized approach. 5. Remove drift and align the airplane using the approved method; go around if control margin is inadequate.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance.

Watch / correct: Holding a fixed correction as airspeed changes - adjust control continuously for the changing effectiveness.

Watch / correct: Touching down while drifting or crabbed beyond aircraft guidance - go around and reset the approach.

Stop / transition: Go around for excessive drift, misalignment, gusts or inadequate control margin. Use aircraft, instructor and endorsement limits; a published demonstrated crosswind is not automatically a legal operating limit.

Reference: AFH: crosswind takeoffs and landings; POH

Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Prioritizes aircraft control, chooses the correct checklist and reaches a defensible landing/diversion decision without random switch changes. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify the abnormal indication. 2. Keep flying and state the immediate risk. 3. Apply only approved memory actions when applicable, then use the checklist. 4. Reassess systems, weather and landing options. 5. Tell the instructor/ATC what help is needed.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Prioritizes aircraft control, chooses the correct checklist and reaches a defensible landing/diversion decision without random switch changes.

Watch / correct: Treating the indication before controlling the airplane - restore control, then diagnose.

Watch / correct: Resetting a breaker or moving a control without authority - consult the aircraft checklist and identify the consequence first.

Stop / transition: End the simulation immediately for a real abnormality, distraction from traffic/terrain or any effect on essential equipment.

Reference: AFH: emergency procedures; POH: systems and abnormal checklists

Simulated engine failure and emergency approach · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains glide control, selects a reachable site early and manages checklist/communications without losing the landing plan. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Establish the POH glide condition. 2. Select a reachable suitable site and plan the approach. 3. Perform approved checklist actions or verbalize unsafe-to-simulate actions. 4. Brief occupants and communications. 5. Evaluate whether the site remains reachable, then recover at the briefed gate.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains glide control, selects a reachable site early and manages checklist/communications without losing the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Searching indefinitely for the perfect field - select a suitable reachable option and refine it.

Watch / correct: Trying to stretch the glide - maintain the POH glide condition and revise the landing plan.

Stop / transition: Recover with power at the prebriefed safe altitude/position or earlier for traffic, terrain, a poor glide plan or aircraft concerns. No surprise engine shutdown or off-airport touchdown.

Reference: AFH: emergency approach; Sport PTS: Emergency Approach and Landing; POH

Go-around from a rejected landing · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Makes the decision early, controls yaw/pitch and transitions to a safe climb without premature configuration changes. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify the assigned unstable-approach cue. 2. Announce and initiate the go-around promptly. 3. Apply approved power and establish the climb attitude. 4. Change configuration in the POH sequence. 5. Maintain runway/traffic separation and communicate when workload allows.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Makes the decision early, controls yaw/pitch and transitions to a safe climb without premature configuration changes.

Watch / correct: Waiting to see whether the landing improves - use the briefed gate and commit to a go-around.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps while still descending - establish the approved climb and configuration sequence.

Stop / transition: Instructor intervenes for a stall tendency, conflict or runway misalignment; do not manufacture an unsafe approach to create a go-around.

Reference: AFH: approaches and go-arounds; Sport PTS: Go-Around/Rejected Landing

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess an independent arrival and landing; provide safety intervention if needed and record it. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Solo readiness requires satisfactory presolo knowledge/corrections, required logged training and consistently safe patterns, landing control and emergency decisions in the intended aircraft. Further coaching to prevent an unsafe outcome means further dual training.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Review Segments as Needed

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 30 - source page 40 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 31 · Human factors and fitness preparation

Review impairment, personal readiness, visual limitations and workload decisions before the first supervised solo gate.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Review impairment, personal readiness, visual limitations and workload decisions before the first supervised solo gate.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 26](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 3: Segment 27](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 32 · First solo: dual gate, parked release and supervised patterns

[Return to lesson index](#)

96 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] DUAL · Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-14 Air 00-06	[] DUAL · Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
14-46 Air 06-38	[] DUAL · Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing	1.
46-56 Air 38-48	[] DUAL · Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
56-60 Ground	[] DUAL · Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.
60-66 Ground	[] SOLO · Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
66-71 Air 48-53	[] SOLO · Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
71-85 Air 53-67	[] SOLO · Supervised traffic-pattern circuits	1.
85-92 Air 67-74	[] SOLO · Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
92-96 Ground	[] SOLO · Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 32

A compound mission: 60 minutes dual first, then a separate 36-minute supervised solo only after a parked instructor release. The source dual and solo targets remain separate.

Source clarification: Source target: 60 minutes dual plus 36 minutes supervised solo. The parked release/endorsement/weather check between portions lies outside flight time and may extend the 12-minute discussion. No solo timer or lesson number authorizes release.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- A compound mission: 60 minutes dual first, then a separate 36-minute supervised solo only after a parked instructor release. The source dual and solo targets remain separate.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Current required solo endorsements, proficiency/knowledge evidence, actual route authorization and weather/fuel limits must be verified by the authorized instructor before release.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: .

- Before release verify student eligibility, current make/model solo endorsement, specific area/airport/route authorization, weather/crosswind limitations, fuel, aircraft condition and ground contact/late-return plan. Apply actual school operating rules where relevant. Review real lost/weather/failure responses; do not intentionally create those conditions alone.

- After the 60-minute dual portion, park and shut down. The instructor verifies independent patterns/landings, endorsements and current conditions, then briefs changed solo handling, allowed circuits, early-return/go-around triggers and ground supervision. Restart for the separate solo only after this release; if any gate fails, remain dual and reschedule.

DUAL · Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe student-led surface operations without prompting; safety intervention means further training is needed. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

DUAL · Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe an independent departure and traffic scan; give only task/route instructions. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

DUAL · Crosswind takeoff, crab and sideslip landing · 32 minutes

Teach / coach: Before flight, assign the setup and recovery/termination gate. Observe without coaching and judge this task-specific result: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance. Intervene for safety, document the assistance and return the task to dual training; a later demonstration is a separate training attempt.

Student exercise: 1. Identify wind and select the briefed technique. 2. Hold runway alignment during takeoff with coordinated controls. 3. Correct drift in the climb. 4. Fly a stabilized approach. 5. Remove drift and align the airplane using the approved method; go around if control margin is inadequate.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance.

Watch / correct: Holding a fixed correction as airspeed changes - adjust control continuously for the changing effectiveness.

Watch / correct: Touching down while drifting or crabbed beyond aircraft guidance - go around and reset the approach.

Stop / transition: Go around for excessive drift, misalignment, gusts or inadequate control margin. Use aircraft, instructor and endorsement limits; a published demonstrated crosswind is not automatically a legal operating limit.

Reference: AFH: crosswind takeoffs and landings; POH

DUAL · Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess an independent arrival and landing; provide safety intervention if needed and record it. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

DUAL · Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

SOLO · Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: before release verify current solo authority, route/area, weather, fuel, aircraft condition and contact/return plan. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

SOLO · Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: observe the authorized departure if practical and retain the agreed contact plan. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

SOLO · Supervised traffic-pattern circuits · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release.

Student exercise: 1. Fly only the released pattern/runway in the briefed weather. 2. Make required calls and maintain separation. 3. Use the normal approved takeoff and landing technique, with wind correction only within the endorsement limits. 4. Go around whenever unstable. 5. End the circuits early if traffic, weather, workload or fuel changes.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Maintains centerline, manages drift and lands aligned without side loading; new crosswind technique may require assistance.

Watch / correct: Holding a fixed correction as airspeed changes - adjust control continuously for the changing effectiveness.

Watch / correct: Touching down while drifting or crabbed beyond aircraft guidance - go around and reset the approach.

Stop / transition: Go around for excessive drift, misalignment, gusts or inadequate control margin. Use aircraft, instructor and endorsement limits; a published demonstrated crosswind is not automatically a legal operating limit.

Reference: AFH: crosswind takeoffs and landings; POH

SOLO · Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: remain reachable, monitor the agreed return window and accept an early return/go-around without pressure to finish repetitions. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

SOLO · Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: meet/debrief after shutdown and verify the actual route, landing counts and any difficulty before another authorization. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- The instructor separately makes the parked solo release; the student then safely completes authorized supervised solo patterns. The dual portion alone does not complete Stage I.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Reconstruct actual route/circuits, full-stop counts and any weather/traffic/authorization change.
- Discuss any go-around, return, diversion or request for help; rehearse the response before the next solo authorization.
- Confirm aircraft securing and actual experience with the instructor, then decide the next specific authorized mission.

Study and sources

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 32 - source page 42 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Performance, pilotage and Sport readiness

Short/soft-field procedures, authorized solo practice, visual-navigation trips, day cross-country, knowledge-test review and current Sport PTS assessment.

Lesson 33 · Principles of navigation

Prepare heading/course references, visual position fixes and wind correction before later pilotage flights.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Prepare heading/course references, visual position fixes and wind correction before later pilotage flights.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 8](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segments 8](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 34 · Short- and soft-field technique introduction

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-37 Air 08-29	[] Short-field takeoff and landing	1.
37-58 Air 29-50	[] Soft-field takeoff and landing	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 34

Connect runway condition and POH performance to short-field obstacle clearance and soft-field ground-effect/gear protection. Use a suitable runway to simulate the condition.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Connect runway condition and POH performance to short-field obstacle clearance and soft-field ground-effect/gear protection. Use a suitable runway to simulate the condition.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Short-field takeoff and landing; Soft-field takeoff and landing.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Short-field takeoff and landing · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Use POH performance, actual runway conditions and a selected obstacle/aiming point. Demonstrate the approved takeoff setup, obstacle-clearance climb and transition. On return show stabilized approach speed, precise touchdown and approved stopping technique.

Student exercise: 1. Calculate usable runway and margins. 2. Apply the POH short-field takeoff procedure. 3. Track centerline and transition only after obstacle clearance. 4. Fly a stable short-field approach at the approved speed. 5. Touch down at the selected point within the applicable lesson/ACS tolerance and stop with directional control.

Practice: One demonstration and one student takeoff-landing pair on introduction; two student pairs on review if the runway/pattern supports them.

Look for: Uses performance data and approved procedures, clears the simulated obstacle and controls touchdown/stopping without chasing a spot unsafely.

Watch / correct: Rotating early to improve distance - use the POH procedure and required control speed.

Watch / correct: Pitching down to hit the spot - go around when the approach cannot remain stable.

Stop / transition: Reject or go around for performance margin, unstable speed, obstacle-clearance uncertainty or poor alignment. Simulate a field condition on a suitable runway rather than using an unsafe short strip.

Reference: AFH: short-field takeoffs and landings; Sport PTS: short-field tasks; POH

Soft-field takeoff and landing · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Explain how to unload the nosewheel and preserve momentum using the POH technique. Demonstrate the ground-effect transition without an early climb at insufficient airspeed. On landing show energy management and protection of the landing gear.

Student exercise: 1. Brief the approved configuration and simulated surface. 2. Maintain the required nosewheel unloading and directional control during the takeoff roll. 3. Accelerate safely in ground effect as prescribed. 4. Transition to the approved climb. 5. Fly a stable soft-field approach and protect the gear through touchdown and roll.

Practice: One demonstration and one student takeoff-landing pair on introduction; two student pairs on review when safe.

Look for: Maintains control and momentum, avoids premature climb and manages touchdown without dropping the nosewheel.

Watch / correct: Pulling out of ground effect before acceleration - lower the pitch appropriately and follow the POH transition.

Watch / correct: Trying to hold the nose up beyond control margin - prioritize directional control and aircraft limits.

Stop / transition: Stop the simulation for inadequate surface/runway suitability or go around for an unstable approach. Use actual soft surfaces only when approved and suitable.

Reference: AFH: soft-field takeoffs and landings; Sport PTS: soft-field tasks; POH

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Student explains the new exercise and performs its sequence with the assistance appropriate to introduction, followed by a corrected repeat when safe.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segments 1-3

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 34 - source page 45 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 35 · Publications and flight-planning equipment

Prepare current charts, Chart Supplement, navigation logs and planning tools before cross-country work.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Prepare current charts, Chart Supplement, navigation logs and planning tools before cross-country work.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segments 4-9](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 36 · Maximum-performance and low-speed review

[Return to lesson index](#)

72 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-28 Air 08-20	[] Short-field takeoff and landing	1.
28-40 Air 20-32	[] Soft-field takeoff and landing	1.
40-46 Air 32-38	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
46-52 Air 38-44	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
52-58 Air 44-50	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 36

Develop smoother short/soft-field performance, then check slow flight and full-stall recovery. Carry the landing slip onto another session if adequate repetitions cannot fit.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Develop smoother short/soft-field performance, then check slow flight and full-stall recovery. Carry the landing slip onto another session if adequate repetitions cannot fit.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Short-field takeoff and landing; Soft-field takeoff and landing; Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario.
- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Short-field takeoff and landing · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Use POH performance, actual runway conditions and a selected obstacle/aiming point. Demonstrate the approved takeoff setup, obstacle-clearance climb and transition. On return show stabilized approach speed, precise touchdown and approved stopping technique.

Student exercise: 1. Calculate usable runway and margins. 2. Apply the POH short-field takeoff procedure. 3. Track centerline and transition only after obstacle clearance. 4. Fly a stable short-field approach at the approved speed. 5. Touch down at the selected point within the applicable lesson/ACS tolerance and stop with directional control.

Practice: One demonstration and one student takeoff-landing pair on introduction; two student pairs on review if the runway/pattern supports them.

Look for: Uses performance data and approved procedures, clears the simulated obstacle and controls touchdown/stopping without chasing a spot unsafely.

Watch / correct: Rotating early to improve distance - use the POH procedure and required control speed.

Watch / correct: Pitching down to hit the spot - go around when the approach cannot remain stable.

Stop / transition: Reject or go around for performance margin, unstable speed, obstacle-clearance uncertainty or poor alignment. Simulate a field condition on a suitable runway rather than using an unsafe short strip.

Reference: AFH: short-field takeoffs and landings; Sport PTS: short-field tasks; POH

Soft-field takeoff and landing · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Explain how to unload the nosewheel and preserve momentum using the POH technique. Demonstrate the ground-effect transition without an early climb at insufficient airspeed. On landing show energy management and protection of the landing gear.

Student exercise: 1. Brief the approved configuration and simulated surface. 2. Maintain the required nosewheel unloading and directional control during the takeoff roll. 3. Accelerate safely in ground effect as prescribed. 4. Transition to the approved climb. 5. Fly a stable soft-field approach and protect the gear through touchdown and roll.

Practice: One demonstration and one student takeoff-landing pair on introduction; two student pairs on review when safe.

Look for: Maintains control and momentum, avoids premature climb and manages touchdown without dropping the nosewheel.

Watch / correct: Pulling out of ground effect before acceleration - lower the pitch appropriately and follow the POH transition.

Watch / correct: Trying to hold the nose up beyond control margin - prioritize directional control and aircraft limits.

Stop / transition: Stop the simulation for inadequate surface/runway suitability or go around for an unstable approach. Use actual soft surfaces only when approved and suitable.

Reference: AFH: soft-field takeoffs and landings; Sport PTS: soft-field tasks; POH

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Use the currently effective Sport airplane PTS task, which specifies the near-stall condition at which another increase in angle of attack/load or reduction in power would produce an immediate stall. Clear, choose a safe recovery floor that permits completion at or above the PTS minimum of 1,500 feet AGL, and follow all aircraft limitations. Demonstrate coordinated straight flight, gentle turns, climb and descent with the requested approved configurations, then recover to cruise. This Sport task differs from the private-certificate slow-flight condition.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One entry, two shallow turns and one recovery; repeat the entry only after identifying the largest error.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: From a safe altitude, show an approach-type full stall with coordinated controls. Identify the first warning and the full-stall indication, then reduce angle of attack, add approved power and clean up in the POH sequence. Contrast the entry with and without flaps.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One entry with flaps and one without on introduction; on review add one briefed turning entry only after straight entries are safe.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Demonstrate the approved departure configuration and controlled pitch-up at the briefed power. Show the rudder required as speed decreases. At the full stall, reduce angle of attack, maintain coordination and restore a safe climb according to the POH.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control

and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry.

Practice: One straight entry, then the other approved configuration or a shallow turning entry on a review lesson; never rush the reset.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

Debrief - 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Repeat or carry forward

- Forward slip to a stabilized landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 1

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 4

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 36 - source page 47 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 37 · Cross-country planning preparation

Prepare route, altitude, weather, heading/time/fuel estimates and landing alternatives before pilotage training.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Prepare route, altitude, weather, heading/time/fuel estimates and landing alternatives before pilotage training.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segments 1-2, 7-8

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segments 5-9

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 38 · Authorized solo practice: maneuver and landing priorities

[Return to lesson index](#)

60 min solo | Brief 12 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 8

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-24 Air 08-16	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
24-32 Air 16-24	[] Steep turns in both directions	1.
32-39 Air 24-31	[] Turns around a point	1.
39-46 Air 31-38	[] Short-field takeoff and landing	1.
46-56 Air 38-48	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
56-60 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 38

Choose only already-proficient maneuvers specifically authorized for this aircraft, area and weather. The source contains more items than can all receive useful practice in one hour.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Choose only already-proficient maneuvers specifically authorized for this aircraft, area and weather. The source contains more items than can all receive useful practice in one hour.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Current required solo endorsements, proficiency/knowledge evidence, actual route authorization and weather/fuel limits must be verified by the authorized instructor before release.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 12 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Steep turns in both directions; Turns around a point; Short-field takeoff and landing.

- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.
- Before release verify student eligibility, current make/model solo endorsement, specific area/airport/route authorization, weather/crosswind limitations, fuel, aircraft condition and ground contact/late-return plan. Apply actual school operating rules where relevant. Review real lost/weather/failure responses; do not intentionally create those conditions alone.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: before release verify current solo authority, route/area, weather, fuel, aircraft condition and contact/return plan. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: observe the authorized departure if practical and retain the agreed contact plan. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit - 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Steep turns in both directions - 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and choose altitude, airspeed and rollout reference. 2. Establish the briefed bank with coordinated controls. 3. Maintain the outside pitch picture and cross-check altitude. 4. Complete the turn, roll out and stabilize. 5. Repeat in the other direction after clearing.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Controls bank, pitch and power without fixation; introductory performance may need coaching, while final assessment uses current Sport PTS tolerances.

Watch / correct: Trying to correct altitude with bank alone - restore the briefed bank and make a small pitch/power correction.

Watch / correct: Looking only inside - return to the outside pitch reference and make short instrument cross-checks.

Stop / transition: Roll out if bank, load, airspeed or altitude approaches an aircraft limit or safe practice boundary; never chase a tolerance through unsafe control inputs.

Reference: AFH: steep turns; Sport PTS: Steep Turns

Turns around a point · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and choose a safe radius and altitude. 2. Enter as briefed. 3. Adjust bank to maintain the ground radius. 4. Keep the ball centered and scan outside. 5. Exit after a full circuit and predict corrections for a second direction.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Holds a consistent radius using coordinated bank changes, with safe altitude and a sustained traffic scan.

Watch / correct: Tightening toward the point when blown inward - reduce bank and re-establish the planned radius.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the point - scan the horizon and traffic, then check the ground reference briefly.

Stop / transition: Leave the maneuver if the required bank exceeds the practice limit, an escape route is compromised or traffic/terrain clearance becomes uncertain.

Reference: AFH: turns around a point; Sport PTS: Ground Reference Maneuvers

Short-field takeoff and landing · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Calculate usable runway and margins. 2. Apply the POH short-field takeoff procedure. 3. Track centerline and transition only after obstacle clearance. 4. Fly a stable short-field approach at the approved speed. 5. Touch down at the selected point within the applicable lesson/ACS tolerance and stop with directional control.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Uses performance data and approved procedures, clears the simulated obstacle and controls touchdown/stopping without chasing a spot unsafely.

Watch / correct: Rotating early to improve distance - use the POH procedure and required control speed.

Watch / correct: Pitching down to hit the spot - go around when the approach cannot remain stable.

Stop / transition: Reject or go around for performance margin, unstable speed, obstacle-clearance uncertainty or poor alignment. Simulate a field condition on a suitable runway rather than using an unsafe short strip.

Reference: AFH: short-field takeoffs and landings; Sport PTS: short-field tasks; POH

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: remain reachable, monitor the agreed return window and accept an early return/go-around without pressure to finish repetitions. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: meet/debrief after shutdown and verify the actual route, landing counts and any difficulty before another authorization. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Complete only the specifically authorized mission and report actual route, landings, repetitions, help requested and early-return/diversion decisions to the instructor.

Debrief · 8 minutes

- Reconstruct actual route/circuits, full-stop counts and any weather/traffic/authorization change.
- Discuss any go-around, return, diversion or request for help; rehearse the response before the next solo authorization.
- Confirm aircraft securing and actual experience with the instructor, then decide the next specific authorized mission.

Repeat or carry forward

- Full power-off stalls: approach scenario: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Full power-on stalls: departure scenario: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Rectangular course: wind correction by leg: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- S-turns across a road: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Soft-field takeoff and landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Forward slip to a stabilized landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 2: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 4

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 38 - source page 49 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 39 - Navigation preparation II

Build the actual route, airport data, heading/time/fuel estimates and weather decisions for the first pilotage trip.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Build the actual route, airport data, heading/time/fuel estimates and weather decisions for the first pilotage trip.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segments 5-9](#)

[Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 6: Segment 5](#)

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 40 · Pilotage to two airports and a position-recovery exercise

[Return to lesson index](#)

108 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-42 Air 08-34	[] Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass	1.
42-64 Air 34-56	[] Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport	1.
64-76 Air 56-68	[] Recover an uncertain position	1.
76-94 Air 68-86	[] Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass	1.
94-104 Air 86-96	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
104-108 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 40

Plan a landmark/compass round trip to an airport more than 25 but less than 50 NM away, plus a landing at another airport within 25 NM of home. Introduce controlled lost-position response while retaining a known safe position.

Source clarification: The 108-minute source target requires a route-specific estimate. Allow actual wind, runway/pattern/taxi and both airport visits; extend rather than shorten required distance, landings or position-recovery practice.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Plan a landmark/compass round trip to an airport more than 25 but less than 50 NM away, plus a landing at another airport within 25 NM of home. Introduce controlled lost-position response while retaining a known safe position.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 20 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass; Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport; Recover an uncertain position; Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass.

- Bring current charts/Chart Supplement, airport diagrams, weather/NOTAM briefing, navigation log and fuel/alternate plan. Verify every required route distance and landing point from the real route. Rehearse Flight Service/CTAF calls while parked; actual flight calls must not interrupt critical control tasks.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show the next prominent checkpoint, chart-to-ground orientation and a heading checked with the compass in stable flight. Compare planned and actual time/fuel. Demonstrate a concise position report or Flight Service contact when useful, without letting communications replace lookout.

Student exercise: 1. Orient the chart and identify two independent position clues. 2. Fly the planned heading with wind correction. 3. Mark actual checkpoint time and revise ETA/fuel. 4. Scan weather and airspace ahead. 5. Explain the next landmark and landing alternative; make the assigned radio contact at a low-workload time.

Practice: At least three checkpoint fixes and two time/fuel updates; use the source route distances rather than a generic local circuit.

Look for: Maintains a continuous position estimate, recognizes drift early and updates ETA/fuel while keeping an outside scan.

Watch / correct: Mistaking one similar feature for the checkpoint - verify with a second independent landmark.

Watch / correct: Ignoring time/fuel after a wind change - update groundspeed, ETA and reserves at the next checkpoint.

Stop / transition: Divert or terminate the exercise for deteriorating weather, uncertain position, unsafe fuel margin or airspace risk; GPS may be used by the instructor for safety without replacing the assigned visual-navigation exercise.

Reference: PHAK: navigation; AFH: cross-country flight; current charts, Chart Supplement and AIM

Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport · 22 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Before arrival, review current runway, pattern, traffic and taxi information. Show how to identify the airport/runway visually, make proper non-towered reports or follow a clearance, then stop at a safe place to review departure information.

Student exercise: 1. Confirm destination position, runway/wind, published pattern and landing performance. 2. Establish radio awareness and visually identify traffic. 3. Join the correct pattern and fly a stable approach. 4. Land, clear and complete checks before heads-down taxi work. 5. Review departure/taxi routing before taking off again.

Practice: One complete arrival-landing-departure at each required destination; do not omit a source-required airport to meet the clock.

Look for: Finds the correct airport/runway, integrates safely with traffic and handles taxi/departure without instructor navigation rescue.

Watch / correct: Descending toward a guessed airport - remain safe and verify the airport before committing.

Watch / correct: Programming or folding charts while crossing a runway - stop at a safe location and perform the task there.

Stop / transition: Go around or divert if airport identity, runway suitability, traffic or weather is uncertain; obtain any required clearance before entering controlled movement/runway areas.

Reference: AIM: airport operations; current Chart Supplement, airport diagram and POH

Recover an uncertain position · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Use an agreed simulated uncertainty while retaining a known safe position. Show stabilizing the airplane, using time/heading/landmarks, identifying a safe navigation aid and requesting assistance early. Discuss climb only when weather, terrain and airspace permit.

Student exercise: 1. Admit uncertainty promptly. 2. Maintain control and a safe altitude/course. 3. Check last known position, elapsed time and fuel. 4. Use appropriate navigation/ATC assistance to establish position. 5. Choose a safe landing plan rather than wandering.

Practice: One deliberate position-recovery exercise with a clear ending fix; solo lessons rehearse this before departure and use it only for real uncertainty.

Look for: Recognizes loss of confidence, asks for help early and re-establishes position without compromising control, fuel or airspace.

Watch / correct: Continuing random turns while searching - stabilize the airplane and work from the last known fix.

Watch / correct: Delaying a radio request through embarrassment - state uncertainty and request assistance early.

Stop / transition: Stop any simulation before actual uncertainty occurs; for a real lost condition, prioritize safety and obtain assistance. Never intentionally get lost on solo.

Reference: PHAK: lost procedures; AIM: assistance and communications

Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show the next prominent checkpoint, chart-to-ground orientation and a heading checked with the compass in stable flight. Compare planned and actual time/fuel. Demonstrate a concise position report or Flight Service contact when useful, without letting communications replace lookout.

Student exercise: 1. Orient the chart and identify two independent position clues. 2. Fly the planned heading with wind correction. 3. Mark actual checkpoint time and revise ETA/fuel. 4. Scan weather and airspace ahead. 5. Explain the next landmark and landing alternative; make the assigned radio contact at a low-workload time.

Practice: At least three checkpoint fixes and two time/fuel updates; use the source route distances rather than a generic local circuit.

Look for: Maintains a continuous position estimate, recognizes drift early and updates ETA/fuel while keeping an outside scan.

Watch / correct: Mistaking one similar feature for the checkpoint - verify with a second independent landmark.

Watch / correct: Ignoring time/fuel after a wind change - update groundspeed, ETA and reserves at the next checkpoint.

Stop / transition: Divert or terminate the exercise for deteriorating weather, uncertain position, unsafe fuel margin or airspace risk; GPS may be used by the instructor for safety without replacing the assigned visual-navigation exercise.

Reference: PHAK: navigation; AFH: cross-country flight; current charts, Chart Supplement and AIM

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.

- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

- Student explains the new exercise and performs its sequence with the assistance appropriate to introduction, followed by a corrected repeat when safe.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Segment 8

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segments 4-10, 17

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 6: Segment 5

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 40 - source page 51 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 41 · Authorized solo pilotage to a nearby airport

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min solo | Brief 12 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 8

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-38 Air 08-30	[] Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass	1.
38-54 Air 30-46	[] Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport	1.
54-66 Air 46-58	[] Short-field takeoff and landing	1.
66-76 Air 58-68	[] Soft-field takeoff and landing	1.
76-86 Air 68-78	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
86-90 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 41

Fly the endorsed route to an airport within 25 NM and return. Practice previously proficient short/soft-field techniques only when specifically authorized and suitable for the runway/weather.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Fly the endorsed route to an airport within 25 NM and return. Practice previously proficient short/soft-field techniques only when specifically authorized and suitable for the runway/weather.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Current required solo endorsements, proficiency/knowledge evidence, actual route authorization and weather/fuel limits must be verified by the authorized instructor before release.

Parked preflight · 20 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 12 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass; Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport; Short-field takeoff and landing; Soft-field takeoff and landing.

- Before release verify student eligibility, current make/model solo endorsement, specific area/airport/route authorization, weather/crosswind limitations, fuel, aircraft condition and ground contact/late-return plan. Apply actual school operating rules where relevant. Review real lost/weather/failure responses; do not intentionally create those conditions alone.
- Bring current charts/Chart Supplement, airport diagrams, weather/NOTAM briefing, navigation log and fuel/alternate plan. Verify every required route distance and landing point from the real route. Rehearse Flight Service/CTAF calls while parked; actual flight calls must not interrupt critical control tasks.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: before release verify current solo authority, route/area, weather, fuel, aircraft condition and contact/return plan. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: observe the authorized departure if practical and retain the agreed contact plan. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass • 22 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Orient the chart and identify two independent position clues. 2. Fly the planned heading with wind correction. 3. Mark actual checkpoint time and revise ETA/fuel. 4. Scan weather and airspace ahead. 5. Explain the next landmark and landing alternative; make the assigned radio contact at a low-workload time.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Maintains a continuous position estimate, recognizes drift early and updates ETA/fuel while keeping an outside scan.

Watch / correct: Mistaking one similar feature for the checkpoint - verify with a second independent landmark.

Watch / correct: Ignoring time/fuel after a wind change - update groundspeed, ETA and reserves at the next checkpoint.

Stop / transition: Divert or terminate the exercise for deteriorating weather, uncertain position, unsafe fuel margin or airspace risk; GPS may be used by the instructor for safety without replacing the assigned visual-navigation exercise.

Reference: PHAK: navigation; AFH: cross-country flight; current charts, Chart Supplement and AIM

Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport • 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Confirm destination position, runway/wind, published pattern and landing performance. 2. Establish radio awareness and visually identify traffic. 3. Join the correct pattern and fly a stable approach. 4. Land, clear and complete checks before heads-down taxi work. 5. Review departure/taxi routing before taking off again.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Finds the correct airport/runway, integrates safely with traffic and handles taxi/departure without instructor navigation rescue.

Watch / correct: Descending toward a guessed airport - remain safe and verify the airport before committing.

Watch / correct: Programming or folding charts while crossing a runway - stop at a safe location and perform the task there.

Stop / transition: Go around or divert if airport identity, runway suitability, traffic or weather is uncertain; obtain any required clearance before entering controlled movement/runway areas.

Short-field takeoff and landing · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Calculate usable runway and margins. 2. Apply the POH short-field takeoff procedure. 3. Track centerline and transition only after obstacle clearance. 4. Fly a stable short-field approach at the approved speed. 5. Touch down at the selected point within the applicable lesson/ACS tolerance and stop with directional control.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Uses performance data and approved procedures, clears the simulated obstacle and controls touchdown/stopping without chasing a spot unsafely.

Watch / correct: Rotating early to improve distance - use the POH procedure and required control speed.

Watch / correct: Pitching down to hit the spot - go around when the approach cannot remain stable.

Stop / transition: Reject or go around for performance margin, unstable speed, obstacle-clearance uncertainty or poor alignment. Simulate a field condition on a suitable runway rather than using an unsafe short strip.

Reference: AFH: short-field takeoffs and landings; Sport PTS: short-field tasks; POH

Soft-field takeoff and landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Brief the approved configuration and simulated surface. 2. Maintain the required nosewheel unloading and directional control during the takeoff roll. 3. Accelerate safely in ground effect as prescribed. 4. Transition to the approved climb. 5. Fly a stable soft-field approach and protect the gear through touchdown and roll.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Maintains control and momentum, avoids premature climb and manages touchdown without dropping the nosewheel.

Watch / correct: Pulling out of ground effect before acceleration - lower the pitch appropriately and follow the POH transition.

Watch / correct: Trying to hold the nose up beyond control margin - prioritize directional control and aircraft limits.

Stop / transition: Stop the simulation for inadequate surface/runway suitability or go around for an unstable approach. Use actual soft surfaces only when approved and suitable.

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: remain reachable, monitor the agreed return window and accept an early return/go-around without pressure to finish repetitions. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: meet/debrief after shutdown and verify the actual route, landing counts and any difficulty before another authorization. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.

- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Complete only the specifically authorized mission and report actual route, landings, repetitions, help requested and early-return/diversion decisions to the instructor.

Debrief - 8 minutes

- Reconstruct actual route/circuits, full-stop counts and any weather/traffic/authorization change.
- Discuss any go-around, return, diversion or request for help; rehearse the response before the next solo authorization.
- Confirm aircraft securing and actual experience with the instructor, then decide the next specific authorized mission.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Review Segments as Needed

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 41 - source page 52 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 42 · Day cross-country: dead reckoning, diversion and descent

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-31 Air 08-23	[] Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass	1.
31-51 Air 23-43	[] Dead reckoning and in-flight prediction	1.
51-66 Air 43-58	[] Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport	1.
66-76 Air 58-68	[] Recover an uncertain position	1.
76-88 Air 68-80	[] Emergency descent: controlled escape from an urgent hazard	1.
88-106 Air 80-98	[] Choose and fly a diversion	1.
106-116 Air 98-108	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
116-120 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 42

Teach prediction by heading/time/wind during a real day cross-country. Add a safe diversion and an emergency-descent simulation; use the trip to reconcile actual dual cross-country experience.

Source clarification: The source 120 flight minutes include the actual cross-country. Verify at least two hours of dual cross-country training in the full Sport experience record; clocked local maneuvers do not automatically qualify as cross-country time.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Teach prediction by heading/time/wind during a real day cross-country. Add a safe diversion and an emergency-descent simulation; use the trip to reconcile actual dual cross-country experience.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.

Parked preflight · 20 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass; Dead reckoning and in-flight prediction; Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport; Recover an uncertain position; Emergency descent: controlled escape from an urgent hazard; Choose and fly a diversion.

- Bring current charts/Chart Supplement, airport diagrams, weather/NOTAM briefing, navigation log and fuel/alternate plan. Verify every required route distance and landing point from the real route. Rehearse Flight Service/CTAF calls while parked; actual flight calls must not interrupt critical control tasks.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student lead the start/taxi checks; coach only a diagnosed error after stopping safely. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the student brief and fly the departure, diagnosing any drift/airspeed issue after a safe climb. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Show the next prominent checkpoint, chart-to-ground orientation and a heading checked with the compass in stable flight. Compare planned and actual time/fuel. Demonstrate a concise position report or Flight Service contact when useful, without letting communications replace lookout.

Student exercise: 1. Orient the chart and identify two independent position clues. 2. Fly the planned heading with wind correction. 3. Mark actual checkpoint time and revise ETA/fuel. 4. Scan weather and airspace ahead. 5. Explain the next landmark and landing alternative; make the assigned radio contact at a low-workload time.

Practice: At least three checkpoint fixes and two time/fuel updates; use the source route distances rather than a generic local circuit.

Look for: Maintains a continuous position estimate, recognizes drift early and updates ETA/fuel while keeping an outside scan.

Watch / correct: Mistaking one similar feature for the checkpoint - verify with a second independent landmark.

Watch / correct: Ignoring time/fuel after a wind change - update groundspeed, ETA and reserves at the next checkpoint.

Stop / transition: Divert or terminate the exercise for deteriorating weather, uncertain position, unsafe fuel margin or airspace risk; GPS may be used by the instructor for safety without replacing the assigned visual-navigation exercise.

Reference: PHAK: navigation; AFH: cross-country flight; current charts, Chart Supplement and AIM

Dead reckoning and in-flight prediction · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Show how the planned course, wind correction, groundspeed and leg time produce a predicted position. At the next visual checkpoint compare prediction with observation, then revise the remaining leg time and fuel estimate.

Student exercise: 1. Record departure/checkpoint time. 2. Fly the calculated heading. 3. Predict when and where the next checkpoint should appear. 4. Verify with pilotage and revise wind/groundspeed. 5. Recompute ETA and fuel for the next leg.

Practice: Two predicted checkpoints and two independent checks of the prediction.

Look for: Uses heading and elapsed time to predict position and notices a discrepancy before it becomes a lost-position problem.

Watch / correct: Recalculating heads-down for too long - write only essentials and pause calculation while controlling/looking outside.

Watch / correct: Accepting a predicted fix without visual confirmation - compare with two ground features.

Stop / transition: Suspend calculation for traffic, workload, worsening weather or position uncertainty; aviate and use an appropriate navigation/ATC safety resource.

Reference: PHAK: dead reckoning and wind correction; Sport PTS: Navigation

Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Before arrival, review current runway, pattern, traffic and taxi information. Show how to identify the airport/runway visually, make proper non-towered reports or follow a clearance, then stop at a safe place to review departure information.

Student exercise: 1. Confirm destination position, runway/wind, published pattern and landing performance. 2. Establish radio awareness and visually identify traffic. 3. Join the correct pattern and fly a stable approach. 4. Land, clear and complete checks before heads-down taxi work. 5. Review departure/taxi routing before taking off again.

Practice: One complete arrival-landing-departure at each required destination; do not omit a source-required airport to meet the clock.

Look for: Finds the correct airport/runway, integrates safely with traffic and handles taxi/departure without instructor navigation rescue.

Watch / correct: Descending toward a guessed airport - remain safe and verify the airport before committing.

Watch / correct: Programming or folding charts while crossing a runway - stop at a safe location and perform the task there.

Stop / transition: Go around or divert if airport identity, runway suitability, traffic or weather is uncertain; obtain any required clearance before entering controlled movement/runway areas.

Reference: AIM: airport operations; current Chart Supplement, airport diagram and POH

Recover an uncertain position · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the first attempt without continuous prompting. After a safe reset, give one diagnosis, show the correction if needed and require another attempt: Use an agreed simulated uncertainty while retaining a known safe position. Show stabilizing the airplane, using time/heading/landmarks, identifying a safe navigation aid and requesting assistance early. Discuss climb only when weather, terrain and airspace permit.

Student exercise: 1. Admit uncertainty promptly. 2. Maintain control and a safe altitude/course. 3. Check last known position, elapsed time and fuel. 4. Use appropriate navigation/ATC assistance to establish position. 5. Choose a safe landing plan rather than wandering.

Practice: One deliberate position-recovery exercise with a clear ending fix; solo lessons rehearse this before departure and use it only for real uncertainty.

Look for: Recognizes loss of confidence, asks for help early and re-establishes position without compromising control, fuel or airspace.

Watch / correct: Continuing random turns while searching - stabilize the airplane and work from the last known fix.

Watch / correct: Delaying a radio request through embarrassment - state uncertainty and request assistance early.

Stop / transition: Stop any simulation before actual uncertainty occurs; for a real lost condition, prioritize safety and obtain assistance. Never intentionally get lost on solo.

Reference: PHAK: lost procedures; AIM: assistance and communications

Emergency descent: controlled escape from an urgent hazard · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Brief a simulated smoke/fire or other urgent descent need using the POH procedure. Verify clear airspace, terrain and recovery altitude. Demonstrate approved configuration, bank, airspeed and checklist priorities without exceeding any limitation.

Student exercise: 1. State the simulated hazard and approved immediate actions. 2. Clear the descent path. 3. Establish the POH emergency-descent procedure. 4. Monitor airspeed, load and terrain. 5. Recover by the briefed safe altitude and decide where to land.

Practice: One demonstration on introduction and one student descent if recovery margin is ample; one independently flown scenario on assessment.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, descends promptly within limits and retains terrain/traffic awareness through recovery.

Watch / correct: Treating maximum descent rate as the only goal - prioritize aircraft limits and terrain clearance.

Watch / correct: Missing the recovery altitude while checking a list - keep the descent path and altitude in the scan.

Stop / transition: Recover earlier than planned if traffic, terrain, speed/load or weather is unfavorable. No real system disabling or descent toward an unsafe floor.

Reference: AFH: emergency descents; Sport PTS: Emergency Descent; POH

Choose and fly a diversion · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate with an explicit control transfer, then coach the student: Present a briefed weather, fuel or destination problem without creating a real hazard. Show selecting a suitable alternative, estimating heading/time/fuel, checking terrain/airspace and changing the flight plan or informing ATC as appropriate.

Student exercise: 1. State the reason to abandon the original plan. 2. Choose a reachable suitable airport. 3. Estimate heading, distance, time and fuel. 4. Check terrain, airspace, weather and runway information. 5. Fly toward it, refine the estimate and explain the new decision gates.

Practice: One complete diversion decision and two position/ETA updates along the new course.

Look for: Chooses early, keeps flying while planning and selects an alternative with safe fuel, terrain and weather margins.

Watch / correct: Choosing the nearest symbol without checking suitability - verify runway, weather and airport status.

Watch / correct: Continuing the old course while calculating - establish a safe interim heading and workload plan.

Stop / transition: End the scenario and provide needed assistance if actual position, weather, terrain or fuel margin is threatened. Do not continue toward a fictitious hazard.

Reference: PHAK: navigation and aeronautical decision-making; Sport PTS: Diversion

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the student brief and fly the arrival; diagnose one energy or alignment issue only after a safe landing/reset. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Reconcile at least two actual hours of qualifying dual cross-country training from the full experience record; do not infer it solely from this 120-minute allocation.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Segments 4-10, 17

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 6: Segment 5

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 42 - source page 53 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 43 · Solo Sport cross-country: 75 NM and two landing points

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min solo | Brief 12 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 8

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-46 Air 08-38	[] Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass	1.
46-66 Air 38-58	[] Dead reckoning and in-flight prediction	1.
66-86 Air 58-78	[] Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport	1.
86-106 Air 78-98	[] Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass	1.
106-116 Air 98-108	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
116-120 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 43

Fly the authorized day route of at least 75 NM total with at least two legs and full-stop landings at at least two points, including a leg of at least 25 NM. Reconcile the cumulative five solo hours separately.

Source clarification: The source 120-minute target is an estimate. Use actual route/leg/taxi timing and fuel reserves; extend the authorization/booking when needed. Verify 75 NM, at least two landing points, a 25 NM leg and cumulative solo experience from actual records.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Fly the authorized day route of at least 75 NM total with at least two legs and full-stop landings at at least two points, including a leg of at least 25 NM. Reconcile the cumulative five solo hours separately.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Current required solo endorsements, proficiency/knowledge evidence, actual route authorization and weather/fuel limits must be verified by the authorized instructor before release.

Parked preflight · 20 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 12 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.

- Preview the ordered exercises: Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass; Dead reckoning and in-flight prediction; Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport; Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass.
- Before release verify student eligibility, current make/model solo endorsement, specific area/airport/route authorization, weather/crosswind limitations, fuel, aircraft condition and ground contact/late-return plan. Apply actual school operating rules where relevant. Review real lost/weather/failure responses; do not intentionally create those conditions alone.
- Bring current charts/Chart Supplement, airport diagrams, weather/NOTAM briefing, navigation log and fuel/alternate plan. Verify every required route distance and landing point from the real route. Rehearse Flight Service/CTAF calls while parked; actual flight calls must not interrupt critical control tasks.
- Verify the specific cross-country endorsements and instructor review of this actual plan/weather before departure; the minimum-distance route does not substitute for that authorization.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: before release verify current solo authority, route/area, weather, fuel, aircraft condition and contact/return plan. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: observe the authorized departure if practical and retain the agreed contact plan. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Orient the chart and identify two independent position clues. 2. Fly the planned heading with wind correction. 3. Mark actual checkpoint time and revise ETA/fuel. 4. Scan weather and airspace ahead. 5. Explain the next landmark and landing alternative; make the assigned radio contact at a low-workload time.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Maintains a continuous position estimate, recognizes drift early and updates ETA/fuel while keeping an outside scan.

Watch / correct: Mistaking one similar feature for the checkpoint - verify with a second independent landmark.

Watch / correct: Ignoring time/fuel after a wind change - update groundspeed, ETA and reserves at the next checkpoint.

Stop / transition: Divert or terminate the exercise for deteriorating weather, uncertain position, unsafe fuel margin or airspace risk; GPS may be used by the instructor for safety without replacing the assigned visual-navigation exercise.

Reference: PHAK: navigation; AFH: cross-country flight; current charts, Chart Supplement and AIM

Dead reckoning and in-flight prediction · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Record departure/checkpoint time. 2. Fly the calculated heading. 3. Predict when and where the next checkpoint should appear. 4. Verify with pilotage and revise wind/groundspeed. 5. Recompute ETA and fuel for the next leg.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Uses heading and elapsed time to predict position and notices a discrepancy before it becomes a lost-position problem.

Watch / correct: Recalculating heads-down for too long - write only essentials and pause calculation while controlling/looking outside.

Watch / correct: Accepting a predicted fix without visual confirmation - compare with two ground features.

Stop / transition: Suspend calculation for traffic, workload, worsening weather or position uncertainty; aviate and use an appropriate navigation/ATC safety resource.

Reference: PHAK: dead reckoning and wind correction; Sport PTS: Navigation

Arrive, land and depart at an unfamiliar airport · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Confirm destination position, runway/wind, published pattern and landing performance. 2. Establish radio awareness and visually identify traffic. 3. Join the correct pattern and fly a stable approach. 4. Land, clear and complete checks before heads-down taxi work. 5. Review departure/taxi routing before taking off again.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Finds the correct airport/runway, integrates safely with traffic and handles taxi/departure without instructor navigation rescue.

Watch / correct: Descending toward a guessed airport - remain safe and verify the airport before committing.

Watch / correct: Programming or folding charts while crossing a runway - stop at a safe location and perform the task there.

Stop / transition: Go around or divert if airport identity, runway suitability, traffic or weather is uncertain; obtain any required clearance before entering controlled movement/runway areas.

Reference: AIM: airport operations; current Chart Supplement, airport diagram and POH

Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Before departure, verify prior dual demonstration and proficiency, then authorize this exact task, location, repetitions and weather limits. Review the student's setup and stop criteria using the aircraft references. Remain available under the agreed supervision/contact plan. No in-flight instructor demonstration or new-task training is possible; missing proficiency means another dual lesson before release. No new demonstration or maneuver instruction occurs during solo; use only the specifically authorized already-proficient exercise.

Student exercise: 1. Orient the chart and identify two independent position clues. 2. Fly the planned heading with wind correction. 3. Mark actual checkpoint time and revise ETA/fuel. 4. Scan weather and airspace ahead. 5. Explain the next landmark and landing alternative; make the assigned radio contact at a low-workload time.

Practice: Perform only the prebriefed authorized repetitions within the allotted block. Skip a task rather than exceed weather, proficiency, endorsement or fuel limits.

Look for: Maintains a continuous position estimate, recognizes drift early and updates ETA/fuel while keeping an outside scan.

Watch / correct: Mistaking one similar feature for the checkpoint - verify with a second independent landmark.

Watch / correct: Ignoring time/fuel after a wind change - update groundspeed, ETA and reserves at the next checkpoint.

Stop / transition: Divert or terminate the exercise for deteriorating weather, uncertain position, unsafe fuel margin or airspace risk; GPS may be used by the instructor for safety without replacing the assigned visual-navigation exercise.

Reference: PHAK: navigation; AFH: cross-country flight; current charts, Chart Supplement and AIM

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: remain reachable, monitor the agreed return window and accept an early return/go-around without pressure to finish repetitions. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Ground supervision: meet/debrief after shutdown and verify the actual route, landing counts and any difficulty before another authorization. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.
- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.
- Complete only the specifically authorized mission and report actual route, landings, repetitions, help requested and early-return/diversion decisions to the instructor.
- Verify at least 75 NM total, at least two legs/full-stop landing points and a leg of at least 25 NM. Reconcile cumulative five solo hours and all actual route endorsements; add authorized solo time if the cumulative requirement remains unmet.

Debrief · 8 minutes

- Reconstruct actual route/circuits, full-stop counts and any weather/traffic/authorization change.
- Discuss any go-around, return, diversion or request for help; rehearse the response before the next solo authorization.
- Confirm aircraft securing and actual experience with the instructor, then decide the next specific authorized mission.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 4: Review Segments as Needed

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 5: Review Segments as Needed

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 43 - source page 54 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 44 · Sport knowledge-test review

Prepare for and pass the applicable Sport Pilot knowledge test, then review the reported deficiency areas before the final flight-readiness assessment.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Prepare for and pass the applicable Sport Pilot knowledge test, then review the reported deficiency areas before the final flight-readiness assessment.

Preparation

- Complete the corresponding current Sporty's Sport ground lesson and preparation before dependent flight work.

[Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks](#)

[Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 45 · Sport PTS preparation and targeted correction

[Return to lesson index](#)

60 min dual | Brief 8 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 4

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-22 Air 08-14	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
22-28 Air 14-20	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
28-34 Air 20-26	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
34-46 Air 26-38	[] Steep turns in both directions	1.
46-56 Air 38-48	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
56-60 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 45

Assess the current Sport PTS standard and prioritize the weakest maneuver areas. The one-hour source target cannot adequately rehearse the entire performance/navigation/emergency list.

Source clarification: This is a targeted 60-minute preparation assessment. Complete missing or deficient source tasks in extended/additional sessions before final readiness; no general proficiency claim comes from these four default exercise blocks.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Assess the current Sport PTS standard and prioritize the weakest maneuver areas. The one-hour source target cannot adequately rehearse the entire performance/navigation/emergency list.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Prepare an independent plan of action and identify required tasks not yet safely demonstrated.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 8 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.
- Preview the ordered exercises: Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario; Steep turns in both directions.

- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.
- State the assessment rules: no coaching during the independent attempt, safety intervention is documented, and all unobserved/deficient required tasks need continued training or assessment. Stage I determines safe solo readiness; the final check uses the current Sport PTS.
- Assess certificates/eligibility, airworthiness, route planning, weather, airspace, aircraft systems/performance, human factors, principles of flight, airport signs/markings/lighting and emergency/survival equipment. Review all knowledge-test deficiency areas and applicable experience/endorsement prerequisites.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe student-led surface operations without prompting; safety intervention means further training is needed. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe an independent departure and traffic scan; give only task/route instructions. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Steep turns in both directions · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Controls bank, pitch and power without fixation; introductory performance may need coaching, while final assessment uses current Sport PTS tolerances. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and choose altitude, airspeed and rollout reference. 2. Establish the briefed bank with coordinated controls. 3. Maintain the outside pitch picture and cross-check altitude. 4. Complete the turn, roll out and stabilize. 5. Repeat in the other direction after clearing.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Controls bank, pitch and power without fixation; introductory performance may need coaching, while final assessment uses current Sport PTS tolerances.

Watch / correct: Trying to correct altitude with bank alone - restore the briefed bank and make a small pitch/power correction.

Watch / correct: Looking only inside - return to the outside pitch reference and make short instrument cross-checks.

Stop / transition: Roll out if bank, load, airspeed or altitude approaches an aircraft limit or safe practice boundary; never chase a tolerance through unsafe control inputs.

Reference: AFH: steep turns; Sport PTS: Steep Turns

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess an independent arrival and landing; provide safety intervention if needed and record it. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.

- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

- Show the required current Sport PTS knowledge and tasks independently. An unobserved task or safety intervention prevents a complete readiness result; this guide grants no certificate or examining authority.

Debrief · 4 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Repeat or carry forward

- Short-field takeoff and landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Soft-field takeoff and landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Rectangular course: wind correction by leg: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- S-turns across a road: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Turns around a point: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Choose and fly a diversion: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Recover an uncertain position: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Simulated engine failure and emergency approach: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Emergency descent: controlled escape from an urgent hazard: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- An unobserved, unsafe or below-standard source requirement must be completed in continued training/assessment before progress; the target duration grants no completion credit.

Study and sources

Sporty's Sport track preparation: Vol 1-6: Review Segments as Needed
Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 45 - source page 56 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource

Lesson 46 · Final Sport readiness assessment

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72 min check | Brief 60 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 30

Publisher lesson-page target; phase allocations authored by SUAREZ.CFI

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation	1.
08-16 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb and safe transit	1.
16-24 Air 08-16	[] Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass	1.
24-32 Air 16-24	[] Choose and fly a diversion	1.
32-40 Air 24-32	[] Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit	1.
40-46 Air 32-38	[] Full power-off stalls: approach scenario	1.
46-52 Air 38-44	[] Full power-on stalls: departure scenario	1.
52-58 Air 44-50	[] Steep turns in both directions	1.
58-68 Air 50-60	[] Return, stabilized approach and final landing	1.
68-72 Ground	[] Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure	1.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 46

Use a complete current Sport airplane PTS plan of action and independent evidence of knowledge, aircraft control, navigation and emergency decisions. Verify the Part 61 experience and endorsement requirements separately.

Source clarification: The source target is 72 flight minutes and 90 discussion minutes, but its complete task list needs more observation time for many students/routes. Continue the assessment for every unobserved/deficient task; do not recommend a practical test from the timer alone.

Single-engine-land airplane Sport pathway, using the current 2026 course portal's October 2025 syllabus and currently effective FAA-S-8081-29B PTS. Check aircraft eligibility under current §61.316 and all privileges/limitations/endorsements in Part 61; the source's older LSA shorthand does not establish current eligibility. Set speeds, power, configuration, recovery floors and performance from the actual POH/AFM and supplements with the instructor. The core route is daytime VFR; any expanded privilege requires its separate current training/endorsement and eligibility conditions.

Objectives

- Use a complete current Sport airplane PTS plan of action and independent evidence of knowledge, aircraft control, navigation and emergency decisions. Verify the Part 61 experience and endorsement requirements separately.
- Use safe setup/control, recognize the earliest error cue and show a corrected repeat or independent assessment evidence appropriate to the lesson.

Before the flight

- Complete the prerequisite ground preparation and resolve unsafe/deficient items from the preceding flight.
- Have the instructor verify actual aircraft eligibility, operational limits and current Sport privileges/endorsements for the proposed mission.
- Prepare an independent plan of action and identify required tasks not yet safely demonstrated.

Parked preflight · 15 minutes

- Review aircraft documents/maintenance status, weather/NOTAMs, loading, fuel and current Sport aircraft/operation eligibility. Instructor verifies suitability and authorization.
- Use the actual POH/AFM walkaround, fuel/oil and defect assessment. Set seats/restraints/controls, secure loose items and prepare charts/radios.
- Give the aircraft-specific passenger/positive-control-transfer briefing; on solo review the specific mission and ground contact plan before release.

Briefing · 60 minutes

- Check the actual aircraft eligibility, limitations and installed supplements with current Sport privileges/endorsements. Select POH speeds/configurations, weather/crosswind limits, runway margins, fuel, practice area and safe recovery boundaries before movement.
- Agree on positive control transfer, instructor lookout and authorized simulations. Keep aircraft control, traffic and terrain ahead of discussion; no intentional spins, surprise shutdowns or hazardous low-altitude failures.

- Preview the ordered exercises: Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass; Choose and fly a diversion; Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit; Full power-off stalls: approach scenario; Full power-on stalls: departure scenario; Steep turns in both directions.
- Explain angle of attack, stall warning/full-stall cues, yaw and spin prevention. This Sport PTS slow-flight condition is near an immediate stall, unlike Private ACS slow flight. Choose enough altitude to finish slow-flight/stall tasks above the applicable current PTS minimum and any higher aircraft/terrain safety floor.
- State the assessment rules: no coaching during the independent attempt, safety intervention is documented, and all unobserved/deficient required tasks need continued training or assessment. Stage I determines safe solo readiness; the final check uses the current Sport PTS.
- Assess certificates/eligibility, airworthiness, route planning, weather, airspace, aircraft systems/performance, human factors, principles of flight, airport signs/markings/lighting and emergency/survival equipment. Review all knowledge-test deficiency areas and applicable experience/endorsement prerequisites.

Start, taxi, run-up and runway confirmation · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe student-led surface operations without prompting; safety intervention means further training is needed. Use the actual start checklist, a clear propeller area, immediate engine indication check, early brake check, airport diagram, hold-short discipline and the before-takeoff checklist. Rehearse any ambiguous taxi clearance while stopped.

Student exercise: 1. Start using the POH checklist and verify indications. 2. Test brakes at an appropriate safe speed. 3. Identify the route and every runway crossing. 4. Use required radio calls/readbacks and obtain crossing clearances. 5. Perform run-up/checks in a suitable location. 6. Confirm runway, wind, takeoff plan and rejection triggers before entry.

Practice: One complete start-to-runway sequence; stop for any uncertain clearance or configuration.

Look for: Correct checklist, route, clearances and runway identified; aircraft remains controlled and no hold line is crossed without authority.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi work - stop in a safe place before consulting a chart or programming equipment.

Watch / correct: Run-up hurried because of traffic - wait and complete the checks before taking the runway.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with an unresolved aircraft discrepancy, uncertain clearance, failed brake/engine check or weather/endorsement exceedance.

Reference: POH: normal procedures; AIM: taxi/runway operations; FAA runway-incursion guidance

Takeoff, climb and safe transit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe an independent departure and traffic scan; give only task/route instructions. Confirm wake separation, runway alignment, aircraft-approved rotation/climb/configuration, crosswind correction and the published/assigned departure. For local work select a legal practice area, clear it and brief recovery boundaries before any maneuver.

Student exercise: 1. Verify traffic, clearance when required and the correct runway. 2. Apply the approved takeoff technique while maintaining centerline and wind correction. 3. Climb at the POH/briefed condition and change configuration as approved. 4. Follow the published/assigned departure or pattern. 5. Level off, trim, complete checks and keep collision-avoidance scans.

Practice: One normal departure; use crosswind technique only within the aircraft and lesson authorization.

Look for: Maintains runway/ground track, a safe climb and separation, then arrives at the intended area with the airplane configured and trimmed.

Watch / correct: Letting the nose drift on power application - use coordinated directional control and stop/reject if required.

Watch / correct: Task briefing during a critical climb - finish the climb/checks before discussing the practice exercise.

Stop / transition: Reject for a real takeoff abnormality per the briefed POH plan; discontinue training for wake, weather, traffic, fuel or terrain/airspace risk. No unbriefed low-altitude engine-failure simulation.

Reference: AFH: normal/crosswind takeoff; POH: climb; AIM: traffic/wake avoidance

Navigate by landmarks and magnetic compass · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Maintains a continuous position estimate, recognizes drift early and updates ETA/fuel while keeping an outside scan. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Orient the chart and identify two independent position clues. 2. Fly the planned heading with wind correction. 3. Mark actual checkpoint time and revise ETA/fuel. 4. Scan weather and airspace ahead. 5. Explain the next landmark and landing alternative; make the assigned radio contact at a low-workload time.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains a continuous position estimate, recognizes drift early and updates ETA/fuel while keeping an outside scan.

Watch / correct: Mistaking one similar feature for the checkpoint - verify with a second independent landmark.

Watch / correct: Ignoring time/fuel after a wind change - update groundspeed, ETA and reserves at the next checkpoint.

Stop / transition: Divert or terminate the exercise for deteriorating weather, uncertain position, unsafe fuel margin or airspace risk; GPS may be used by the instructor for safety without replacing the assigned visual-navigation exercise.

Reference: PHAK: navigation; AFH: cross-country flight; current charts, Chart Supplement and AIM

Choose and fly a diversion · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Chooses early, keeps flying while planning and selects an alternative with safe fuel, terrain and weather margins. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. State the reason to abandon the original plan. 2. Choose a reachable suitable airport. 3. Estimate heading, distance, time and fuel. 4. Check terrain, airspace, weather and runway information. 5. Fly toward it, refine the estimate and explain the new decision gates.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Chooses early, keeps flying while planning and selects an alternative with safe fuel, terrain and weather margins.

Watch / correct: Choosing the nearest symbol without checking suitability - verify runway, weather and airport status.

Watch / correct: Continuing the old course while calculating - establish a safe interim heading and workload plan.

Stop / transition: End the scenario and provide needed assistance if actual position, weather, terrain or fuel margin is threatened. Do not continue toward a fictitious hazard.

Reference: PHAK: navigation and aeronautical decision-making; Sport PTS: Diversion

Slow flight: configuration, coordination and exit · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and confirm the aircraft configuration and safe recovery floor. 2. Establish the instructor-briefed current Sport PTS slow-flight condition. 3. Hold heading/altitude with coordinated controls and trim. 4. Make briefed gentle turns, a climb and a descent without exceeding control margin. 5. Recover to ordinary flight in the POH sequence; explain the effect of angle of attack, load and power.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains the agreed near-stall condition, coordination and safe recovery margin with lesson-appropriate assistance. At the final Sport PTS assessment, use the current specified altitude/heading/airspeed/bank tolerances rather than applying Private Pilot ACS criteria.

Watch / correct: Bank increasing while the ball moves off center - reduce bank and coordinate rudder before continuing.

Watch / correct: Retracting flaps abruptly - use the approved sequence and manage the resulting pitch/sink change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an actual stall, loss of coordination, unsafe altitude trend, aircraft restriction or the prebriefed floor. A warning cue expected in the agreed near-stall condition is assessed in context; unexpected deterioration requires recovery. Complete the task no lower than the current Sport PTS minimum, and use a higher floor when safety/POH requires it. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: slow flight; Sport PTS: Slow Flight

Full power-off stalls: approach scenario · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and brief the recovery floor. 2. Select the assigned approved flap configuration. 3. Establish the approach-type descent and enter the stall with coordinated controls. 4. Recognize the full stall, recover promptly and return to climb/cruise. 5. Repeat the alternate configuration only after a stable reset.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Recognizes the full stall, promptly unloads and restores controlled flight without a secondary stall; assistance level follows the lesson gate.

Watch / correct: Delaying the unload while reaching for controls - reduce angle of attack before attending to configuration.

Watch / correct: Retracting all flaps while still sinking - use the approved incremental recovery sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw, a wing drop that exceeds the briefed demonstration, an aircraft limitation or the recovery floor; no intentional spin demonstration.

Reference: AFH: power-off stalls; Sport PTS: Power-Off Stalls; POH

Full power-on stalls: departure scenario · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and select the approved entry configuration and power. 2. Establish a coordinated departure-type entry. 3. Identify the full-stall indication. 4. Reduce angle of attack, maintain directional control and recover. 5. Reset before any approved turning entry.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Maintains coordination through entry and recovery, recognizes the stall and avoids a secondary stall while returning to a safe climb.

Watch / correct: Rudder pressure unchanged as speed decreases - actively cross-check coordination and adjust rudder.

Watch / correct: Aiming for an extreme pitch attitude - use the approved entry and judge the stall by aerodynamic cues.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for developing yaw/roll divergence or the recovery floor; instructor takes control before a spin tendency develops. No intentional spins.

Reference: AFH: power-on stalls; Sport PTS: Power-On Stalls; POH

Steep turns in both directions · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign this task under the prebriefed plan of action, retain safety lookout and observe independent execution. Look for this task-specific result: Controls bank, pitch and power without fixation; introductory performance may need coaching, while final assessment uses current Sport PTS tolerances. Apply the current Sport PTS or Stage I solo-readiness criteria as appropriate. Do not demonstrate, hint or coach; document any safety intervention and mark unobserved elements for a continued assessment.

Student exercise: 1. Clear and choose altitude, airspeed and rollout reference. 2. Establish the briefed bank with coordinated controls. 3. Maintain the outside pitch picture and cross-check altitude. 4. Complete the turn, roll out and stabilize. 5. Repeat in the other direction after clearing.

Practice: One independently performed task sequence; repeat only under the assessor's stated policy. A coached retry is training, not the original independent result.

Look for: Controls bank, pitch and power without fixation; introductory performance may need coaching, while final assessment uses current Sport PTS tolerances.

Watch / correct: Trying to correct altitude with bank alone - restore the briefed bank and make a small pitch/power correction.

Watch / correct: Looking only inside - return to the outside pitch reference and make short instrument cross-checks.

Stop / transition: Roll out if bank, load, airspeed or altitude approaches an aircraft limit or safe practice boundary; never chase a tolerance through unsafe control inputs.

Reference: AFH: steep turns; Sport PTS: Steep Turns

Return, stabilized approach and final landing · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess an independent arrival and landing; provide safety intervention if needed and record it. Recheck weather/traffic, airport/runway identity, landing performance, pattern entry and the aircraft-specific stabilized-approach gate. Teach an early go-around decision whenever safe landing is uncertain.

Student exercise: 1. Secure maneuver/route work and complete descent checks. 2. Confirm airport/runway, wind and pattern/clearance. 3. Join with traffic awareness and an appropriate radio report. 4. Fly the approved stable approach and manage wind correction. 5. Land aligned and maintain control through rollout, or go around early.

Practice: One complete arrival and final landing; include a go-around whenever the real approach fails the briefed gate.

Look for: Maintains traffic separation and a stable approach; touches down aligned with adequate runway margin or makes an early safe go-around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the landing to finish on time - go around and accept additional flight time.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the aiming point - maintain airspeed, alignment, traffic and runway margin in the scan.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable path/speed, drift, clearance uncertainty or unsafe runway margin; divert if weather, fuel or lighting makes return unsuitable.

Reference: AFH: traffic patterns and landings; POH; AIM: airport operations

Clear, taxi in, shut down and secure · 4 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe after-landing and securing without distraction; inspect the learner's checklist completion and aircraft condition. Keep the airplane controlled until clear of the runway, then use after-landing/taxi/shutdown checklists. Account for keys, tie-downs/chocks, discrepancies and postflight reporting.

Student exercise: 1. Clear the runway fully and stop when needed before after-landing checks. 2. Follow the cleared/briefed taxi route with wind correction. 3. Park and shut down using the POH checklist. 4. Secure the aircraft and inspect for discrepancies. 5. Report actual tasks/counts and any concern before leaving.

Practice: One complete runway-exit-to-secured-aircraft sequence; parked debrief follows this flight block.

Look for: Runway is clear before heads-down work; aircraft is safely shut down/secured and discrepancies are communicated.

Watch / correct: Doing cleanup during rollout - maintain control and wait until clear.

Watch / correct: Leaving a tie-down/checklist item unverified - walk around and confirm the secured condition.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi and request assistance for an uncertain clearance, brake/control problem or obstruction; do not leave an unsecured or unreported discrepant aircraft.

Reference: POH: after landing, shutdown and securing; AIM: taxi

Completion criteria

- Complete all required tasks safely, including any named unfinished work in continued training; preserve actual aircraft/traffic/weather/fuel margins.

- Evaluate actual control, decisions and assistance level rather than elapsed minutes. Use the applicable current Sport PTS and Part 61 gate; early instruction is not a final practical-test result.

- Show the required current Sport PTS knowledge and tasks independently. An unobserved task or safety intervention prevents a complete readiness result; this guide grants no certificate or examining authority.
- Verify the applicable current Sport ASEL experience: at least 20 total hours, 15 with an authorized instructor, five solo, two dual cross-country, ten full-stop takeoffs/landings with pattern work, qualifying solo cross-country and two hours of recent practical-test preparation within the required preceding two calendar months. Review knowledge-test deficiencies, eligibility and endorsements separately.

Debrief • 30 minutes

- Ask for the earliest error/decision cue, then compare the first and final attempt with actual control and assistance evidence.
- Reconcile actual flight/solo/cross-country time and full-stop counts in the appropriate records outside this temporary guide.
- Name the next corrected exercise and verify every unfinished source requirement before moving on.

Repeat or carry forward

- Short-field takeoff and landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Soft-field takeoff and landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Forward slip to a stabilized landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Go-around from a rejected landing: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Rectangular course: wind correction by leg: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- S-turns across a road: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Turns around a point: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Recover an uncertain position: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Recognize an equipment failure and choose a safe action: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- Simulated engine failure and emergency approach: no adequate dedicated block is assigned in this target flight. Add/extend a safe training or assessment block before declaring the source lesson complete.
- An unobserved, unsafe or below-standard source requirement must be completed in continued training/assessment before progress; the target duration grants no completion credit.

Study and sources

Current Sport airplane PTS: lesson-related tasks

Current FAA Airplane Flying Handbook: related maneuver procedures

Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO: lesson 46 - source page 58, 59 - Sporty's Sport Pilot TCO, October 2025; current 2026 course portal resource